Microsoft Privacy Statement

Last Updated: September 2026
What's New?

Cookies

Most Microsoft sites use cookies, small text files placed on your device which web servers utilise and, in the domain that placed the cookie, can retrieve later. We use cookies to store your preferences and settings, help with sign-in, provide personalised ads and analyse site operations. For more information, see the Cookies and similar technologies section of this privacy statement.

EU-U.S., UK Extension, and Swiss-U.S. Data Privacy Frameworks

Microsoft complies with the EU-U.S., UK Extension to the EU-U.S., and Swiss-U.S. Data Privacy Frameworks. To learn more, see the section, and visit the U.S. Department of Commerce's Data Privacy Framework website.

Contact us

If you have a privacy concern, complaint, or question for the Microsoft privacy team or Data Protection Officer, please visit our privacy support and requests page and click on "Contact the Microsoft privacy team or the Microsoft Data Protection Officer" menu. For more information about contacting Microsoft, including Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited, see the How to contact us section of this privacy statement.

Your privacy is important to Microsoft. This privacy statement explains the personal data we process, how we process it, and for what purposes.

Microsoft offers a wide range of products, including server products used to help operate enterprises worldwide, devices customers use in their homes, software that students use at school, and services developers use to create and host new products. References to Microsoft products in this statement include Microsoft services, websites, apps, software, servers, and devices.

Please read the product-specific details in this privacy statement, which provide additional relevant information. This statement applies to the interactions Microsoft has with you and the Microsoft products listed below, as well as other Microsoft products that display this statement.

You can find details about personal data collected from children in the Collection of data from children section. Young people may find it helpful to start with the Privacy for young people page.

For individuals in the United States, please refer to our (including notice at collection details) and the Consumer Health Data Privacy Policy for additional information about your rights and the processing of your personal data.

Please see the Enterprise and developer products section of this privacy statement for more information about how we process data from organisations that use our products and services, like businesses and schools. If you use a Microsoft product or a Microsoft account provided by your organisation, please see the Products provided by your organisation and the Microsoft account sections for more information.

Personal data we collect

Microsoft collects data from users, through your interactions with us and through your use of our products. We collect data in order to operate, improve, and provide you with the best possible experiences. Some data is provided directly by you, while we collect other data based on how you use our products and communicate with us. The types and amount of data we collect depend on how you interact with Microsoft, your choices, privacy settings, and the features you use, as well as applicable law.

The data we collect can include the following:

Name and contact details. Your first and last name, email address, mailing address, phone number, and other similar contact details.

Account credentials. Information used to access your account, such as username, password, and password hints.

Demographic data. Details about you like your age, gender, country, and language preference.

Payment data. Details needed to process payments, including credit card numbers and security codes.

Subscription and licensing data. Details about your product subscriptions, licences, and other entitlements.

Interactions. Information about your use of Microsoft products, including features you use, searches, commands given, error reports, and support requests.

- **Device and usage data**. Data about your device and product features you use, hardware and software details, product performance, your interactions with our websites and apps, and your settings. For example:
  - **Payment and account history**.
  - **Browsing history**.
  - **Device, connectivity, and configuration data**. For example, IP addresses, device identifiers, nearby networks, and other information about the operating systems and other software installed on your device.
  - **Error reports ("crash dumps") and performance data**. This usually includes software, hardware, and file content details related to an error, and other software on your device.
  - **Troubleshooting and help data**. Data you provide when you contact Microsoft for help. For example, contact or authentication data, the content of your communications with Microsoft, the condition of your device, the products at issue, and other details that help us provide support. Phone

conversations or chat sessions with our representatives may be monitored and recorded.
    - **Bot usage data**. Interactions with bots and skills available through Microsoft products, including bots and skills provided by third parties.
- **Interests and favourites**. Preferences and interests you share (like favorite sports teams, preferred programming languages, or cities for weather or traffic) or that we infer from your activity, such as your activity on sites that use our technology for ads purposes.
- **Content consumption**. Information about the media content you access through our products like TV, video, music/audio, apps, and games.
- **Searches and commands**. Search queries and commands you provide in Microsoft products, such as interactions with a chat bot.
- **Voice data**. Also referred to as "voice clips," this includes spoken queries commands, or dictation, and may include background sounds. Learn more about how Microsoft uses and protects voice data in its speech recognition technologies.
- **Text, inking, and typing data**. Data and related information you provide by typing, inking, or using touch input in Microsoft products.
- **Images**. Images and related data, like picture metadata. For example, we collect the image you provide when you use a Bing image-enabled service or upload an image to Microsoft Copilot.
- **Contacts and relationships**. Data about your contacts and relationships if you use a product to manage contacts, share information or communicate with others, or improve your productivity.
- **Traffic data**. Data about your use of Microsoft's communication services, including whom you've contacted and when.
- **Social data**. Information about your interactions and relationships with others, such as likes, events, and other types of engagement.
- **Location data**. Data about your device's location, which may be either precise (typically based on GPS, mobile mast, or WiFi hotspot location) or imprecise (for example, inferred from an IP address, or city or postcode in your account profile).
- **Biometric data**. Unique data about you from specific technical processing related to your physical, physiological, or behavioural characteristics to verify or confirm your identity. For instance, you can use your fingerprint or facial recognition to sign in to your Windows device via Windows Hello (please see the section below for more information). Our collection and use of biometric data depends on the products and features you use and your consent.
- **Other input**. Data generated from using devices or participating in events, like buttons you press on an XBOX controller or other activity data, or information you provide when registering or attending an in-person event.

Content. Information in files and messages, emails, chats, calls, meetings, photos, documents, and other media you create or share using Microsoft products.

Video and audio recordings at Microsoft locations. Recordings of events and activities at Microsoft buildings, retail spaces, and other locations, which may include your image and voice data.

Feedback and ratings. Information you provide in feedback, surveys, or product reviews.

Product-specific sections below describe data collection practices applicable to use of those products.

We also receive data from Microsoft affiliates, subsidiaries, and third parties. We protect data obtained from third parties according to the practices described in this statement, plus any additional restrictions imposed by the source of the data. These third-party sources vary over time and include:

- Data brokers from which we purchase demographic data and contact information to supplement the data we collect.
- Services that make user-generated content from their service available to others, such as reviews of local businesses or public social media posts.
- Communication services, including email providers and social networks, when you give us permission to access your data on such third-party services or networks.
- Service providers that help us determine your device's location.
- Partners with whom we engage in joint marketing activities.
- Developers who create experiences through or for Microsoft products.
- Third parties that deliver experiences through Microsoft products.
- Publicly available sources, such as open public sector, academic, and commercial data sets.

You have choices when it comes to the data you share. When you are asked to provide personal data, you can decline. You can also use web browser, in-product, or operating system controls to limit or prevent certain types of automatic data collection. Many of our products require some personal data to operate and provide you with a service. If you choose not to provide or allow us to collect required data, you cannot use the related product or feature. Likewise, where we need to collect personal data by law or to enter into or carry out a contract with you and you do not provide the data, we will

not be able to enter into or carry out the contract. Where providing the data is optional, and you choose not to share personal data, features such as personalisation that use the data will not work for you.

How we use personal data

Microsoft uses the data we collect to provide you with rich, interactive experiences. We also use the data to operate our business, which includes analysing our performance, meeting our legal obligations, developing our workforce, and doing research. Microsoft is committed to protecting the security of your personal data and uses a variety of security technologies and procedures to help protect your personal data from unauthorised access, use, or disclosure. For example, we store personal data you provide on computer systems that have limited access and are in controlled facilities. When we transmit highly confidential data (such as credit card number or password) over the internet, we protect it through the use of encryption.

Specifically, we use data to:

- **Provide our products**. We use data to operate and deliver our products, such as processing files you upload to OneDrive so you can access, edit, and manage them. This also includes:
    - **Communications**. We may use your data to contact you for various reasons, such as to inform you about your subscriptions, tell you when product updates are available, or contact you about your account.
    - **Personalisation**. Many products include personalised features and use automated processes to tailor your experience based on your data and inferences based on your activities, interests, and location. You can sync settings across devices via your Microsoft account, and many products allow you to turn off personalised features.
    - **Product activation**. We use data like device and application type, location, and unique identifiers to activate products.
    - **Transactions**. We use data like your payment and contact information to carry out your transactions with us and deliver your purchases.
    - **Customer support**. We use the data to help us troubleshoot and resolve issues, repair devices, investigate security incidents, and to provide, improve, and secure the quality of our products, services, and training. We may use voice data from support calls for authentication and security purposes.
    - **Security and Safety**. We use data to protect the security and safety of our products and customers, such as by detecting malware and malicious activities. We reserve the right to block communications or remove content that violates our terms of use. We use scanning technologies (like hash matching) to help prevent harm to our systems, our users, and others as described in our Code of Conduct, and to help prevent child exploitation. We may share information with the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) and law enforcement authorities. We also use tools to detect and disrupt the misuse of video-calling capabilities to produce and share child sexual exploitation and abuse imagery by high-risk users. Learn more about our efforts to prevent and detect child exploitation here.
    - **Providing Age Appropriate Experiences**. We use information associated with your Microsoft account to provide more age-appropriate experiences across our services. This may include information you provide, such as your date of birth or settings you choose in your account, information from your use of Microsoft services, such as how you interact with features, content, and products, or information from partners or verification services, such as age range signals received from app stores. We use this information to help us apply age-appropriate protections, settings, and experiences. When we apply age-based protections, we generally apply them across Microsoft services connected to your account so that your experience is consistent. We may share age group information with Microsoft apps and services, as well as third-party apps, so that they can apply appropriate safeguards, tailor experiences, and comply with applicable laws and regulations.
    - **Troubleshooting and Updates**. We use data to troubleshoot and resolve performance issues, develop updates and security patches, and notify users of product updates. This may include using automated systems to detect security and safety issues.
- **Product Improvement and Development**
    - **Product improvement**. We use data to improve our products, including adding new features and capabilities. For example, we use error reports to improve security features, queries and clicks in Bing to improve search results, and voice data to develop and improve speech recognition accuracy.
    - **Product development**. We use data to develop new products. For example, we use data, often de-identified, to better understand our customers'

computing and productivity needs, and to train and fine-tune AI models, which can shape the development of new products. As part of our efforts to improve and develop our products, we may use your data to develop, train, and fine-tune our AI models, including large language models (LLMs). Learn more here.

- **Marketing, Advertising, and Promotions**
  - **Promotional communications**. We use data to send you promotional messages. See the How to access and control your personal data section for information on managing your contact data, email subscriptions, and promotional messages.
  - **Relevant offers**. Microsoft uses data to provide you with product information and offers likely to interest you, such as new games based on your activity.
  - **Advertising**. We use data for advertising on Microsoft and third-party properties, sometimes using automated processes to make ads more relevant. Microsoft does not use what you say in emails, human-to-human chat, video calls or voice mail, or your personal files, photos, or documents to target ads to you. See the Advertising section for more details.
  - **Prize promotions and events**. We use your data to administer prize contests and events and to select winners. For example, if you enter into a prize promotion, we may use your data to select a winner and provide the prize to you if you win.
- **Business Operations**
  - **Reporting and business operations**. We use data to analyse and improve our business, make informed decisions, and report on our business' performance.
  - **Protecting rights and property**. We use data to detect and prevent fraud, resolve disputes, enforce agreements, and protect our property. For example, we use data to confirm software licences to reduce piracy and combat fraud. We may use automated processes to detect and prevent activities that violate our rights and the rights of others, such as fraud.
  - **Legal compliance**. We process data to comply with applicable laws. For example, we use the age of our customers to assist us in meeting our obligations to protect children's privacy.
- **Research**. With appropriate safeguards for individuals' rights and freedoms, we use data for research, including AI and machine learning, for public interest and scientific purposes.

We combine data collected from different contexts or obtained from third parties to give you a more seamless, consistent, and personalised experience, to make informed business decisions, and for other legitimate purposes. For example, Microsoft Store uses information about the apps and services you use to make personalised app recommendations. We use technological and procedural safeguards to prevent certain data combinations; for example, we store data collected from unauthenticated users separately from account information that directly identifies you, such as your name, email address, or phone number.

Our processing of personal data involves both automated and manual (human) methods, which often work together. For example, to build, train, and improve the accuracy of our automated systems – such as AI - we manually review some of the results against the underlying data.

Legal bases for processing

We process your personal data with your consent and/or when it's necessary to provide the products you use, operate our business, meet our contractual and legal obligations, protect the security and safety of our systems and our customers, or pursue our legitimate interests or those of third parties. Our reasons for using your data are described here and in the section. Our legal basis for processing may vary depending on how and across what products or services we process your data. When we rely on legitimate interests, we consider and balance those interests against your rights and freedoms and will only process your data if these interests are not outweighed by your own.

Our retention of personal data

Microsoft retains personal data for as long as necessary to provide the products and services you use and to fulfil the transactions you request. We also retain personal data for other legitimate purposes such as operating our business, meeting our contractual and legal obligations, improving and developing our products and services, protecting the safety and security of our systems and customers, and resolving disputes. Because these needs can vary for different data types and the context of our interactions with you or your use of our products, actual retention periods can vary significantly. See relevant product documentation for more information.

Criteria used to determine retention periods include:

- The purposes for which we use the information. For example, when you store a document in OneDrive, we maintain the data until you actively delete it.
- The nature and sensitivity of the information. For example, we maintain a shortened retention period for precise geolocation information.

- Legal, contractual, and other similar obligations we are subject to, including data retention laws, government orders to preserve data relevant to an investigation, or data retained for the purposes of litigation. Conversely, we'll remove unlawful content where required by law.

Reasons we disclose personal data

We disclose your personal data with your consent, as necessary to complete any transaction or provide any product you have requested or authorised, or as needed to carry out any other purpose described in section. For example, we provide your content to third parties when you tell us to do so, such as when you send an email to a friend or link accounts with another service.

If you use a work or school account or use a Microsoft product provided by an organisation you are affiliated with, such as an employer or school, we disclose certain data such as interaction data and diagnostic data to enable your organisation to manage the products.

We will disclose payment data to banks and other payment transaction processors and financial services providers to fulfil your purchases with us, and for fraud prevention and credit risk reduction. If you save a payment method (such as a card) to an account used by you and other Microsoft account holders, your purchase receipts may be available to anyone else who uses and has access to the same payment method to make a purchase from Microsoft.

When you permit push notifications for Microsoft products or applications on a non-Windows device, we may send data to an external notification provider to deliver push notifications. Your device's push notification services are governed by their own service-specific terms and privacy statements.

We also disclose personal data for digital advertising purposes. Please see the section for more information about how personal data is used for advertising.

In addition, we enable access to personal data among Microsoft-controlled affiliates and subsidiaries, including for the purposes described in this privacy statement. We also provide personal data to vendors or agents working on our behalf for the purposes described in this statement, such as companies we hire to provide customer service support. These companies must comply with our data privacy and security standards and may not use your data for other purposes. We may also disclose personal data as part of corporate transactions such as mergers or asset sales.

Finally, we retain, access, transfer, disclose, and preserve personal data, including your content (like the content of your emails in Outlook.com or files in OneDrive), when we have a good faith belief that it is necessary to do any of the following:

- Comply with applicable law or respond to valid legal process, including from law enforcement or other government agencies.
- Protect the safety of our customers, organisations, and the public – for example, to prevent spam; stop attempts to defraud or otherwise cause harm, or to detect, prevent, and combat harmful or illegal behaviour including the creation and sharing of harmful or illegal content.
- Operate and maintain the security of our products, including to prevent or stop an attack on our computer systems or networks.
- Protect the rights or property of Microsoft, including enforcing the terms governing the use of our services. If we receive information indicating our services are used to traffic in stolen property, we may refer the matter to law enforcement.

For more information about data we disclose in response to requests from law enforcement and other government agencies, please see our Law Enforcement Requests Report.

Please note that some of our products include links to or otherwise enable you to access products of third parties whose privacy practices differ from those of Microsoft. For example, third-party applications or extensions that run on Windows or Edge browser may collect personal data based on their own practices. If you provide personal data to any of those products, your data is governed by their privacy policies.

How to access and control your personal data

You can make choices about the collection and use of your data by Microsoft. You can control your personal data that Microsoft has obtained, and exercise your data protection rights, by contacting Microsoft or using various tools we provide (described below).

Microsoft provides you with the following data protection rights regardless of your location:

- If Microsoft obtained your consent to use your personal data, you can **withdraw that consent** at any time.
- You have the **right to be informed** about the collection and use of your personal data.
- You can request **access to**, **erasure of**, and **updates** to your personal data.
- If you'd like to **port** your data elsewhere, you can use tools Microsoft provides to do so, or if none are available, you can contact Microsoft for assistance.
- You can also **object to or restrict** the use of your personal data by Microsoft. For example, you can object at any time to our use of your personal data for direct marketing purposes or where we are performing a task in the public interest or pursuing our legitimate interests or those of a third party.

In some cases, your ability to access or control your personal data will be limited, as required or permitted by applicable law. If your organisation, such as your employer, school, or service provider, provides you with access to and is administering your use of Microsoft products, contact your organisation to learn more about how to access and control your personal data.

The tools most useful to access and control your personal data that Microsoft has obtained depends on our interactions with you and your use of our products. The following is a general list of tools we provide to help you control your personal data; specific products may provide additional controls. Please refer to the product specific sections below for more information about how you can access your data through other in-product features.

- **Bing.** If you are signed into Bing with your Microsoft account, you can view and clear your stored search and chat history on your privacy dashboard. If you are not signed in, you can view and clear stored search history associated with your device in your Bing settings.
- **Microsoft Copilot**. If you are signed into Microsoft Copilot with your Microsoft account, you can view, access, export and delete Copilot activity history from your privacy dashboard. You can also use in-product controls to manage your data within the Microsoft Copilot website or app.
- **Microsoft account.** You can visit the Microsoft account website if you want to access, edit, or remove your account's profile and payment information, change your password, add security information or close your account.
- **Microsoft privacy dashboard**. You can control some of the data Microsoft processes via your Microsoft account on the Microsoft privacy dashboard. For example, you can view and clear the browsing, search, and location data associated with your Microsoft account.
- **Microsoft Store.** You can access your Microsoft Store profile and account information by visiting Microsoft Store and selecting **View account** or **Order history.**
- **Microsoft Teams for personal use.** You can find out how to export or delete Teams data relating to your personal Microsoft account by visiting this page.
- **OneDrive.** You can view, download, and delete your files and photos in OneDrive by signing into your OneDrive.
- **Outlook.com.** You can download your emails in Outlook.com by signing into your account and navigating to your **Privacy and data** settings.
- **Skype**. If you wish to access, edit, or remove some profile information for Skype or change your password, sign in to your account. If you wish to export your Skype chat history and files shared on Skype, you can request a copy.
- **XBOX**. If you use the XBOX network or XBOX.com, you can view or edit your personal data, including billing and account information, privacy settings, and online safety and data sharing preferences by accessing on the XBOX console or on XBOX.com.

Not all personal data processed by Microsoft can be accessed or controlled via the tools above. If you want to access or control personal data processed by Microsoft that is not available via the tools above or directly through the Microsoft products you use, you can contact Microsoft at the address in the How to contact us section or by visiting our privacy support and requests page.

Your communications preferences

You can choose whether to receive promotional communications from Microsoft by email, SMS, mail, or phone. To opt out of promotional emails or SMS, follow the directions in the message. For more options – including managing contact info, Microsoft-wide contact preferences, email subscriptions, and sharing info with partners – sign in to your personal Microsoft account, and visit your communication permissions page. If you don't have a Microsoft account, you can manage your Microsoft email contact preferences by using this web form. These choices do not apply to mandatory service communications or other informational messages with their own unsubscribe method.

Your advertising choices

To opt out of receiving personalised advertising from Microsoft (including Xandr) visit our Personalised ads and offers page. You can also see our third-party ad partners and opt out of data sharing for personalised ads at our Third-party ad settings page. When you're logged into your Microsoft account, your opt out choice will be associated with

your account and applied across devices whenever you are signed in. If you are not signed in and choose to opt out, your preference is stored in a browser-specific cookie on your device, valid for five years; if you delete cookies, you must opt out again.

For Microsoft-controlled ads in Windows apps, use the opt-out linked to your personal Microsoft account, or turn off the advertising ID in Windows settings to opt out of personalised advertising.

Data used for personalised advertising is also used for other required purposes, such as product delivery, analytics, and fraud detection. You will still see ads even if you opt out of personalised ads, but they may be less relevant to you.

You can opt out of personalised advertising from third-party partners by visiting their sites. Please see our section below for more information.

Browser-based controls

When you use a browser, you can control your personal data using certain features. For example:

- **Cookie controls**. You can control the data stored by cookies and withdraw consent to cookies by using the browser-based cookie controls described in the Cookies section.
- **Tracking protections**. You can control the data third-party sites can collect about you using Tracking Protection in Microsoft Edge. This feature will block third-party content, including cookies, from any site that is listed in a Tracking Protection List you add.
- **Universal Opt-Outs**. Microsoft receives and responds to the Global Privacy Control (GPC) browser opt-out signal in certain jurisdictions. Microsoft will turn off sharing your data with third parties for personalised ads and turn off the "Share my data with third parties for personalised ads" toggle if we receive a GPC signal from you when you visit our sites.

Cookies and similar technologies

We use cookies and similar technologies to store and honour your preferences and settings, enable you to sign-in, provide personalised advertising, combat fraud, analyse how our products perform, and fulfil other legitimate purposes described below. Some cookies are placed by third parties acting on our behalf. Microsoft apps use additional identifiers, such as the Advertising ID in Windows, for similar purposes, and many of our websites and applications also contain web beacons or other similar technologies, as described below.

How we use cookies and similar technologies

- **Preferences and settings**. We use cookies to store and save your choices – like language settings or your ad preferences – so you don't need to set them again.
- **Sign-in and authentication**. We use cookies to verify your identity and keep you signed in securely. When you sign in with a Microsoft account, we store a unique ID number and the time you signed in in an encrypted cookie on your device, so you don't have to repeatedly sign in.
- **Security**. We use cookies to protect our products and detect fraud and abuse.
- **Storing information**. We use cookies to remember information you provide, such as items in your shopping cart.
- **Social media**. Some of our websites include social media cookies, which may let you share content with social media services if you're signed in with them.
- **Feedback**. We use cookies so you can give feedback on our websites.
- **Personalised advertising**. We use cookies to personalise ads based on your activity. You can opt out as described in the How to access and control your personal data section of this privacy statement. We also use web beacons and similar technologies to understand which Microsoft ads displayed on third-party websites and digital platforms drive visitors to our sites and apps. These tools also help us deliver ads on external sites and platforms. See below for more information about web beacons and analytics services.
- **Ad delivery and reporting**. We use cookies to record ad views and clicks, such as which ads you have seen. This helps us, for example, avoid showing the same ad repeatedly.
- **Analytics**. We use cookies to gather usage and performance data, such as visitor counts and other statistics about our websites and products.
- **Performance**. We use cookies to help us understand and improve how our products and websites work, like gathering data to help with load balancing and uptime.

Where required, we obtain your consent prior to placing or using optional cookies. Please see the How to control cookies section below for more information.

Some of the cookies we commonly use and some of the purposes they may be used for are listed below. This list is not exhaustive, but it is intended to illustrate the primary purposes for which we typically set cookies. If you visit one of our websites, the site will

set some or all of the following cookies:

- **MSCC**. Contains user choices for most Microsoft properties.
- **MUID, MC1, MSFPC, and ai_user**. Identifies unique web browsers visiting Microsoft sites. These cookies are used for necessary operational purposes. With consent, these cookies may also be used for advertising.
- **ESTSAUTH, ESTSAUTHLIGHT, ESTSAUTHPERSISTENT**. Helps to authenticate you when you sign in with your Microsoft account.
- **MS0**. Identifies a specific session.
- **NAP**. Contains an encrypted version of your country, postcode, age, gender, language and occupation, if known, based on your Microsoft account profile.
- **MR**. Resets or refreshes the MUID cookie.
- **x-ms-gateway-slice, ARRAffinity, ARRAffinitySameSite, ASLBSA, and ASLBSACORS**. Identifies a gateway for load balancing.
- **TOptOut**. Records your decision not to receive personalised advertising delivered by Microsoft. Where required, we place this cookie by default and remove it when you consent to personalised advertising.
- **ApplicationGatewayAffinity** and **ApplicationGatewayAffinityCORS**. Used for load balancing purposes and to ensure requests for a user session are handled by the same server.
- **esctx, _RequestVerificationToken, .AspNetCore.Correlation, and .AspNetCore.Nonce**. Assist with the security of your website visit and stability of the services provided to you by helping prevent fraud and malicious attacks.

We may also use the cookies of other Microsoft affiliates, companies, and partners, such as LinkedIn and Xandr.

Third-Party Cookies

In addition to the cookies Microsoft sets when you visit our websites, we also use cookies from third parties to enhance the services on our sites. Some third parties can also set cookies when you visit Microsoft sites. For example, when we hire companies to perform services on our behalf, like site analytics, and when companies deliver content on our sites, like videos, news, or ads.

These companies use the data they process in accordance with their privacy policies, which may enable them to collect and combine information about your activities across websites, apps, or online services.

The following types of third-party cookies may be used, depending on the context, service or product, as well as your settings and permissions:

- **Social media cookies.** These cookies help us and third parties show you ads and content tailored to your interests, based on your social media profiles and activity on our websites.
- **Analytics cookies.** Analytics cookies from third parties collect information on how you use our websites to help us improve them and allow third parties to develop and improve their own products. They may also be used for advertising purposes.
- **Advertising cookies.** Advertising cookies record which ads you've seen, which ads you've clicked, or the purchases you've made after clicking. They show you ads relevant to you, like ads based on your social media interests and website browsing history.
- **Required cookies.** Required cookies enable core website functions, such as login, preferences, shopping carts, performance, and security.

For a list of the third parties that set cookies on our websites, please visit our third party cookie inventory. On some of our websites, a list of third parties is available directly on the site and may not be included in our third party cookie inventory. Please consult the third-party websites or privacy notices for more information on their privacy practices with respect to their cookies that may be set on our websites.

How to control cookies

Most web browsers automatically accept cookies but provide controls that allow you to block or delete them. For example, in Microsoft Edge, you can block or delete cookies by selecting **Settings** > **Privacy and services** > **Clear Browsing data** > **Cookies and other site data**. For more information about how to view, block, or delete your cookies in Microsoft Edge, please see our Manage cookies in Microsoft Edge page. If you use a different browser, refer to that browser's instructions. If you choose to block cookies, you cannot sign in or use some of those features, and preferences that are dependent on cookies will be lost. If you delete your cookies, any settings and preferences controlled by those cookies, including advertising preferences, are deleted and will need to be recreated.

Where required, we obtain your consent before placing or using optional cookies that are not (i) strictly necessary to provide the website; or (ii) for the purpose of facilitating a communication. We separate these optional cookies by purpose, including advertising, analytics, and social media purposes. Where consent is required, you can adjust your choices by clicking "Manage cookies" in the footer of the website or through the settings made available on the website. Certain features of Microsoft products depend on cookies.

Additional privacy controls that can impact cookies, including the tracking protections feature of Microsoft browsers, are described in the How to access and control your personal data section of this privacy statement.

Web beacons and analytics services

Some Microsoft webpages use electronic tags called web beacons to deliver cookies, count visitors, and deliver products. We also use web beacons or similar technologies in our communications to determine whether you open and act on them.

We sometimes place our web beacons on other companies' websites or ads to help us understand how interactions with Microsoft advertisements lead to actions, such as purchases, or to learn about your activity on partner sites in connection with Microsoft products or services.

Microsoft products often include web beacons or similar technologies from third-party analytics providers. These providers help us compile statistics about our campaigns and operations. They may set or read their own cookies or identifiers on your device to collect information about your online activities across websites and apps. However, we prohibit these providers from using web beacons on our sites to collect or access information that directly identifies you, such as your name or email address. You can opt out of data collection or use by some of these analytics providers by visiting any of the following sites: Adjust, AppsFlyer, Clicktale, Flurry Analytics, Google Analytics (requires you to install a browser add-on), Kissmetrics, Mixpanel, Nielsen, Acuity Ads, WebTrends, or Optimizely.

Other similar technologies

Our products can also use other similar technologies to store and read data files on your computer. This is typically done to maintain your preferences or to improve speed and performance by storing certain files locally. These technologies can also store a unique identifier for your computer, which can then track behaviour.

Microsoft account

A **Microsoft account** is a personal account that lets you sign into Microsoft products and those of select partners. This account includes personal data such as your credentials, name and contact data, payment data, device and usage data, contacts, information about your activities, and interests and favourites. Signing into your Microsoft account helps personalise your experience, provides consistent experiences across products and devices, enables cloud storage, lets you make payments with stored payment methods, and enables other features.

A **work or school account**, also known as a Microsoft Entra ID account, is an account that is provided and managed by your organisation, such as your employer or school. You can use it to sign in to Microsoft products and third-party products that your organisation provides. If you sign into Microsoft products with a work or school account, please note:

- Your organisation controls your account and can access and process your data, including your communications, files, and content in products you use with your account.
- Your use of these products is subject to your organisation's policies. Review your organisation's privacy and security policies before using your work or school account for personal use.
- If you lose access to your work or school account (for example, if you change employers), you may also lose access to products or content purchased or accessed with that account.
- If you use a work or school email address to create a Microsoft account, your organisation may access your data associated with your Microsoft account.
- Microsoft is not responsible for your organisation's privacy or security practices, which may differ from our own standards.
- Direct any privacy questions or requests (such as to access, correct, or delete your data) to your administrator. See the section for more information about your rights.

Contact your organisation if you're unsure if your account is a work or school account.

A third-party account is a Microsoft account that you or your service provider (such as a cable or internet service provider) create that is tied to your email address with your service provider's domain. Your service provider has control over your account, including the ability to access or delete your account. You should carefully review the terms the third party provided to you to help you understand what the service provider can do with your account and data.

Your Microsoft account. The data associated with your Microsoft account, and how that data is used, depends on how you use the account.

- **Creating your Microsoft account**. When you create a Microsoft account, you'll be asked to provide certain personal data and we'll assign you a unique ID. For some products, like those involving payments, a real name is required, but many products can be used without it. Data such as your display name, email address, and phone number can help others find you on Microsoft products (for example, on Microsoft Teams for personal use). In some cases, you may need to switch to a personal email address to continue accessing consumer-oriented products like the XBOX network.
- **Signing in to your Microsoft account**. When you sign in to your Microsoft account, we log details like the date and time, product accessed, sign-in name, account and device identifiers, IP address, and operating system and browser information.
- **Signing in to Microsoft products**. Signing in to Microsoft products enables improved personalisation, provides consistent experiences across products, permits cloud storage access, and lets you make payments using information stored in your account, along with other settings and features. Information saved to your account may be available across Microsoft products. If you add your account to a Windows device (version 8 or higher), Windows will automatically sign you in to Microsoft products on that device. When signed in, some products will show your name or username and profile photo (if you have one) in Microsoft products, communications, and public posts. .
- **Signing in to third-party products**. If you sign in to a third-party product or make payments to third-party merchants using your Microsoft account, Microsoft shares data with the third party as needed, including your account version number and whether your account has been deactivated. Third parties may use or share your data per their own privacy policies. You should carefully review the privacy policies for each product or merchant you use to understand how your data will be handled.

Collection of data from children

For users under the age of 13 or as specified by law in their jurisdiction, certain Microsoft products and services will either block users under that age or require parental or guardian consent or authorisation before use, including when creating an account. See the section for more information about how we provide age appropriate experiences.

When we receive parental consent or authorisation, the child's account is treated much like any other account, and the child will be able to use Microsoft services such as Outlook, Bing, and XBOX, and communicate or share data with other users. We will not knowingly ask children under the age of consent to provide more data than is necessary to provide the product.

As mentioned in the section, we do not deliver personalised advertising to children whose birthdate in their Microsoft account identifies them as under 18 years of age. For more details, see the section of this privacy statement and Learn more about parental consent and Microsoft child accounts.

Parents or guardians (“parents”) can change or revoke consent at any time. As the organiser of a Microsoft family group, parents can manage their child’s information and settings on the Family Safety page and view or delete a child’s data on the privacy dashboard. Accounts created with parental consent are automatically added to consenting adult’s family group. For child accounts that don’t need parental consent to be created, parents can add the child account to their family group after account creation. See the section for more information.

Accessing and deleting child data. For Microsoft products and services that require parental consent, parents can view and delete certain data about their child, such as browsing history, search history, location activity, and app usage by signing into the parent’s privacy dashboard.

Some Microsoft products, including XBOX, also have their own in-product controls. Please note that a parent’s ability to access and/or delete their child’s personal information may vary depending on the laws where they’re located. For more details on controlling data within Microsoft products, visit our Privacy Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs).

If your child’s account is not part of your Microsoft Family group and you do not have access to their activity on your privacy dashboard, submit a request related to your child’s data through the privacy support form. The privacy team will ask for account verification before fulfilling the request. We process authenticated deletion requests within 30 days of receipt.

To delete all your child’s personal information, request deletion of the child’s account using the close your account form. Sign in to your child’s account, ensure the correct account is shown, and follow the instructions. See Learn more about how to close a Microsoft account.

After requesting account closure, the account is marked for deletion, but we will wait 60 days before permanently deleting the account in case you change your mind or need to access information. After 60 days, the account will be permanently deleted.

For more information on XBOX features, in-product controls, and the associated personal data collection, use, and disclosure, please see the XBOX section of this privacy statement.

Storage and processing of personal data

Personal data collected by Microsoft may be stored and processed in your region, in the United States, and in any other jurisdiction where Microsoft or its affiliates, subsidiaries, or service providers operate facilities. Microsoft maintains major data centres in Australia, Austria, Brazil, Canada, Finland, France, Germany, Hong Kong, India, Ireland, Japan, Korea, Luxembourg, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Africa, the United Kingdom and the United States. Typically, the primary storage location is in your region or in the United States, often with a backup to a data centre in another region. Storage location(s) are chosen in order to operate and provide our services efficiently, improve performance, and create redundancies in order to protect the data in the event of an outage or other problem.

We transfer personal data from the country of origin to other countries, including those that may not offer the same level of data protection as determined by the European Commission or your local data protection authority. In such cases, we implement legal safeguards-such as standard contractual clauses approved by the European Commission – to help protect your rights and ensure your data remains protected. The EU has also determined that certain non-EU countries have an "adequate" level of personal data protection, similar to EU law. For more information on the EU's adequacy decisions and other methods of protecting personal data in countries where Microsoft processes data, please visit the European Commission website.

Please refer to the Reasons we share personal data section for more information on Microsoft's sharing of data, which include when we transfer data to another country.

Microsoft Corporation complies with the EU-U.S. Data Privacy Framework (EU-U.S. DPF), the UK Extension to the EU-U.S. DPF, and the Swiss-U.S. Data Privacy Framework (Swiss-U.S. DPF) as set forth by the U.S. Department of Commerce. Microsoft Corporation has certified to the U.S. Department of Commerce that it adheres to the EU-U.S. Data Privacy Framework Principles (EU-U.S. DPF Principles) with regard to the processing of personal data received from the European Union in reliance on the EU-U.S. DPF and from the United Kingdom (and Gibraltar) in reliance on the UK Extension to the EU-U.S. DPF. Microsoft Corporation has certified to the U.S. Department of Commerce that it adheres to the Swiss-U.S. Data Privacy Framework Principles (Swiss-U.S. DPF Principles) with regard to the processing of personal data received from Switzerland in reliance on the Swiss-U.S. DPF.

In the context of an onward transfer, Microsoft Corporation has responsibility for the processing of personal data it receives under the DPF and subsequently transfers to a third party acting as an agent on our behalf. Microsoft Corporation remains liable under the DPF if our agent processes such personal data in a manner inconsistent with the DPF, unless Microsoft Corporation can prove that we are not responsible for the event giving rise to the damage. If there is any conflict between the terms in this privacy statement and the EU-U.S. DPF Principles and/or the Swiss-U.S. DPF Principles, the Principles shall govern. To learn more about the Data Privacy Framework (DPF) programme, and to view our certification, please visit the US Department of Commerce's Data Privacy Framework website. The controlled U.S. subsidiaries of Microsoft Corporation, as identified in our self-certification submission, also adhere to the DPF Principles—for more info, see the list of Microsoft U.S. Entities Covered by Data Privacy Framework Certification.

If you have a question or complaint related to participation by Microsoft in the DPF Frameworks, we encourage you to contact us via our privacy support and requests page. For any complaints related to the DPF Frameworks that Microsoft cannot resolve directly, we have chosen to co-operate with the relevant EU Data Protection Authority, or a panel established by the European data protection authorities, for resolving disputes with EU individuals, the UK Information Commissioner for resolving disputes with UK individuals, and the Swiss Federal Data Protection and Information Commissioner (FDPIC) for resolving disputes with Swiss individuals. Please contact us if you'd like us to direct you to your data protection authority contacts. As further explained in the DPF Principles, binding arbitration is available to address residual complaints not resolved by other means. Microsoft is subject to the investigatory and enforcement powers of the U.S. Federal Trade Commission (FTC).

Individuals whose personal data is protected by Japan's Act on the Protection of Personal Information should refer to the article on the Japanese Personal Information Protection Commission's website (only published in Japanese) for more information on

the commission's review of certain countries' personal data protection systems. For individuals in Japan, please click here for additional information on the processing of information under the Telecommunications Business Act (in Japanese only).

Advertising

Advertising helps us provide, support, and improve some of our products. Microsoft does not use what you say in email, human-to-human chat, video calls or voice mail, or your documents, photos, or other personal files stored on your device or cloud storage to target ads to you. We use other data for advertising on Microsoft and third-party properties.

Ads may be shown that relate to the current interaction you are having with us, such as your Copilot conversations (including files you share); your current location; transactions; product usage; search queries; or the content you're viewing. For example, if you search "pizza places in Seattle" on Bing, you may see ads for local restaurants in Seattle in your search results.

Where permitted, ads can also be personalised using information about you collected over time, like demographic data, location, search queries, interests, purchase history, favourites, usage of our products and sites, and information from advertisers and partners. We call these kinds of ads "personalised advertising." For example, viewing gaming content on may result in you later seeing game ads on MSN.

Personalised ads use cookies combined with information we collect when your browser interacts with our sites (like your IP address.) Data from cookies will not be used for personalised ads if you opt-out of receiving such ads. To learn more about Microsoft's use of data to deliver personalised advertising and to opt out of receiving personalised advertising from Microsoft, please visit our personalised ads & offers settings page, and see our Opting Out section below.

Certain products have their own personalised ads settings. For example, if you're signed in with your Microsoft account, subject to your privacy settings, we use your online activity in Microsoft Edge to show you personalised ads. You can adjust your Edge privacy settings under **Microsoft Edge > Settings > Privacy and Services**. In Windows, if the advertising ID is enabled in your Windows privacy settings, third parties can access and use it to deliver ads in apps.

Further details regarding our advertising-related uses of data:

- **Advertising industry best practices and commitments**. Microsoft participates in industry self-regulatory programmes and adheres to the NAI Self-Regulatory Framework. We also adhere to the following self-regulatory programmes:
  - In the US: Digital Advertising Alliance (DAA)
  - In Europe: European Interactive Digital Advertising Alliance (EDAA)
  - In Canada: Ad Choices: Digital Advertising Alliance of Canada (DAAC) / Choix de Pub: l'Alliance de la publicité numérique du Canada (DAAC)
- **Children and advertising**. We do not deliver personalised advertising to children whose birthdate in their Microsoft account identifies them as under 18 years of age.
- **Sensitive Data**: Microsoft Advertising does not collect, process, or disclose personal data that qualifies as "sensitive data" under applicable U.S. state data privacy laws for the purposes of providing personalised advertising.

Opting Out. To opt out of receiving personalised advertising from Microsoft, visit our personalised ads and offers page. To opt out of sharing data with third parties for personalised ads, please visit our third-party ad settings page. When you're logged into your Microsoft account, your opt out choice will be associated with your account and applied across devices whenever you are signed in. If you are not signed in and choose to opt out, your preference is stored in a browser-specific cookie on your device, valid for five years; if you delete cookies, you must opt out again.

Microsoft receives and responds to the Global Privacy Control (GPC) browser opt-out signal in certain jurisdictions. Microsoft will turn off sharing your data with third parties for personalised ads and turn off the "Share my data with third parties for personalised ads" toggle if we receive a GPC signal from you when you visit our sites.

Data collected by or disclosed to other advertising companies. Advertisers sometimes include their own or other advertising partners' web beacons within their ads that we display, enabling them to set and read their own cookies. In some cases, we share reports with advertisers about the data we have collected on their sites or ads. Additionally, Microsoft partners with Xandr (a Microsoft Company) and third-party ad companies to help provide some of our advertising services, and we also allow other third-party ad companies to display advertisements on our sites. These third parties may place cookies on your devices and collect data about your online activities across websites or online services. These companies currently include, but are not limited to: Facebook, Media.net, Outbrain, Taboola and Yahoo. See our Cookies and similar technologies section for more information.

We may provide collected data to internal and external partners, including Xandr, other subsidiaries and affiliates, Yahoo, Facebook, or Trade Desk to help make sure the ads you see in our products and theirs, or on other sites, are more relevant to you. Individuals in the United Kingdom can learn more about The Trade Desk's advertising practices in the UK and opt out of The Trade Desk's processing of their data here. Many of these companies participate in the DAA (U.S.), EDAA (Europe) or DAAC (Canada), which provide industry-wide choice tools to opt out of ad targeting from participating companies.

Other important privacy information

Diagnostic data

Many Microsoft products collect diagnostic data to keep our services secure and up-to-date; help ensure they work as expected; detect, diagnose, and fix problems; and improve our products. Diagnostic data can include information about crashes, performance, and your usage of our products.

There are two levels of diagnostic data: required diagnostic data and optional diagnostic data. Products that collect diagnostic data will always collect required diagnostic data, but you can control whether to send us optional diagnostic data.

- **Required diagnostic data**. The minimum data necessary to help keep our products, apps and services secure, up to date, and performing as expected. This includes information about your device, the Microsoft software you are using, settings, capabilities, and performance.
- **Optional diagnostic data**. Additional diagnostic data about your use of a device, application, accessories, or other products and services, which helps us improve our products and detect and fix issues. This may also include data about the websites you browse, device activity (also sometimes referred to as usage), and enhanced error reporting.

See the Microsoft Privacy Report for more information about how we use diagnostic data.

Preview or free-of-charge releases

Microsoft offers preview, insider, beta or other free-of-charge products and features ("previews") to enable you to evaluate them while providing data about your use of the product, including feedback and device and usage data. As a result, previews can automatically collect additional data, provide fewer controls, and otherwise employ different privacy and security measures than those typically present in our products.

Changes to this privacy statement

We update this privacy statement when necessary and to provide greater transparency, such as in response to feedback from customers, regulators, industry, or other stakeholders; changes in our products; changes in our data processing activities or policies; or changes in applicable laws.

When we post changes to this statement, we will revise the "last updated" date at the top of the statement and describe the changes on the Change history page. If there are material changes to the statement, such as a change to the purposes of processing personal data that is not consistent with the original purpose for collection, we will provide prominent notice of the change before it takes effect. We encourage you to periodically review this privacy statement for updates.

How to contact us

If you have a privacy concern, complaint, or question for the Microsoft privacy team or the Data Protection Officer for your region, please visit our privacy support and requests page and click on the "Contact the Microsoft privacy team or the Microsoft Data Protection Officer" menu. We will respond to questions or concerns within a period of no longer than 30 days or where otherwise required by law. You can also raise a concern or lodge a complaint with a data protection authority or other official with jurisdiction.

When Microsoft is a controller, unless otherwise stated, Microsoft Corporation and, for those in the European Economic Area, the United Kingdom, and Switzerland, Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited are the data controllers for

personal data we collect through the products subject to this statement. Our addresses are:

- Microsoft Privacy, Microsoft Corporation, One Microsoft Way, Redmond, Washington 98052, USA. Telephone: +1 (425) 882 8080.
- Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited, Attn: Data Protection Officer, One Microsoft Place, South County Business Park, Leopardstown, Dublin 18, Ireland. Telephone: +353 1 706 3117.

To find the Microsoft subsidiary in your country or region, see the list of Microsoft office locations around the world.

The representative of Microsoft Ireland Operations Limited within the meaning of Art. 14 of the Swiss Federal Act on Data Protection is Microsoft Schweiz GmbH, The Circle 02, 8058 Zürich-Flughafen, Switzerland.

If you would like to exercise your rights under applicable U.S. state data privacy law, you may contact Microsoft at the U.S. address listed above, use our privacy support and requests page, or call our U.S. toll free number +1 (844) 931 2038.

If you are located in Brazil, you may contact us under the LGPD .

If you are a next of kin, more information about managing your deceased loved one's Microsoft accounts is available on our page.

If you have a technical or support question, please visit Microsoft Support to learn more about Microsoft Support offerings. If you have a personal Microsoft account password question, please visit Microsoft account support.

We offer various means for you to control your personal data that Microsoft has obtained, and to exercise your data protection rights. You can do so by contacting Microsoft at our privacy support and requests page or the information above, or by using the various tools we provide. Please see the How to access and control your personal data section for additional details.

Artificial Intelligence and Copilot capabilities

The Microsoft Copilot family of services, products, and solutions leverages generative AI technologies to generate outputs. Microsoft's collection and use of data may differ depending on the service and the intended functionality in a given scenario.

Our use of AI is subject to Microsoft's AI Principles and Microsoft's Responsible AI Standard, and our collection and use of personal data in developing and deploying our AI features is consistent with our commitments outlined throughout our privacy statement. You can find out more about the tools, practices, and policies Microsoft has created to uphold our responsible AI principles here.

The Microsoft Copilot website and app (on Windows, Mac, iOS, and Android) are the core of the consumer Copilot experience, where you can search the web, create content, and interact with features like Copilot Vision, as well as let Microsoft Copilot interact with other apps, services, and websites to take actions on your behalf. When you use Microsoft Copilot, it will use your prompts, location, language, and related settings to provide helpful responses and improve services.

For users in some markets, Microsoft Copilot can use your conversation history (including any memories you save) to personalise your experience. We may also offer you the ability to personalise your Microsoft Copilot experience using your interactions with our other products and services, like Bing, Edge, and MSN. You can manage your memories and control personalisation features using the settings in Microsoft Copilot at any time.

Microsoft Copilot also uses prompts and related data to provide and improve services, including relevant advertising. You can manage your prompt history in product and on the Microsoft Privacy Dashboard, and can adjust your location, language, and other additional privacy settings in product. For more information about these capabilities and your choices, see Microsoft Copilot for individuals: your privacy controls and choices.

We also use your conversation data to monitor performance, troubleshoot and fix bugs and issues, prevent abuse, and to provide and improve Microsoft Copilot. Please review the Transparency Note for Microsoft Copilot for information on our safety practices and our efforts to ensure that Microsoft Copilot is consistent with our Responsible AI principles.

Microsoft Copilot also appears in other Microsoft products like Microsoft Edge and XBOX. In these cases, data is generally used according to each product's primary uses. For more information, see the and sections of this privacy statement.

If you use Microsoft Copilot in third-party products and services, such as messaging platforms, Microsoft processes your data as described here, but the third party's privacy policies and data processing activities may also apply.

For enterprise customers, Microsoft Copilot offers enhanced data protection and customisation. Data is collected and used as described in the Enterprise and Developer Products section.

The Microsoft Copilot features that appear in Microsoft 365 apps as part of a Microsoft 365 Personal, Microsoft 365 Family, or Microsoft 365 Premium subscription provide AI-powered productivity capabilities through real-time conversational experiences. We do so by applying large language model (LLM) processing on the content you choose to provide in Microsoft 365 apps including Word, Excel, OneNote, Outlook, and PowerPoint. Microsoft Copilot in Microsoft 365 is not available for use in Office desktop licences. When used with available Microsoft 365 apps, Microsoft Copilot will use the content in your files only when you ask it to perform a specific action on that specific content – for example, when you ask Microsoft Copilot to help you rewrite a paragraph in a Word document or ask Microsoft Copilot to generate a to-do list from your notes in OneNote. Similar to connected experiences, required service data is collected during your use of Microsoft Copilot which includes information related to its operation that is needed to keep the underlying service secure, up to date, and performing as expected. If you use Microsoft Copilot features in Microsoft 365 apps, Microsoft Copilot handles data as described in the Productivity and Communications section of this privacy statement.

See the Microsoft Copilot Privacy Centre and Frequently asked questions about Copilot in Microsoft 365 subscriptions for more information.

Copilot Health is a consumer Copilot offering specifically developed to provide personalised assistance focused on health and wellness. Copilot Health allows you to upload health-related data including your personal health records and data from wearable devices. Copilot Health can use that data, along with your prompts and chat history, to provide you with personalised information and recommendations.

The information you choose to submit to Copilot Health is used to provide and operate the Copilot Health service. It is not used to develop or train generative AI models, and it is not used for advertising or marketing purposes. Please see the Copilot Health FAQs for more information.

Enterprise and developer products, and products provided by your organisation

Enterprise and Developer Products are Microsoft products and related software offered to and designed primarily for use by organisations and developers. For example:

- Enterprise Online Services (referred to as "Online Services" in the Product Terms) that our enterprise customers contract with us for, such as Microsoft 365, Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Dynamics 365, and Microsoft Intune.
- Other enterprise and developer cloud-based services, such as Azure PlayFab Services (to learn more see Azure PlayFab Terms of Service).
- Other enterprise and developer software, such as Windows Server, Microsoft SQL Server, Visual Studio, System Center, Azure Stack and open-source software like Bot Framework solutions ("Developer Software").
- Appliances and hardware used for storage infrastructure ("Enterprise Appliances").
- Professional services referred to in the Product Terms that are available with Enterprise Online Services, such as onboarding services, data migration services, data science services, or services to supplement existing features in the Enterprise Online Services. To learn more, see Microsoft Professional Services.

In the event of a conflict between this Microsoft privacy statement and the terms of any agreement(s) between a customer and Microsoft for Enterprise and Developer Products, the terms of those agreement(s) will control.

You can also learn more about our Enterprise and Developer Products' features and settings, including choices that impact your privacy or your end users' privacy, in product documentation.

When a customer like your employer or school uses, purchases, or subscribes to Enterprise and Developer Products, or obtains support for our professional services with such products, Microsoft collects and generates data to provide the service, conduct our business operations, and communicate with the customer. For example:

- When a customer engages with a Microsoft sales representative, we collect the customer's name and contact data, along with information about the customer's organisation, to support that engagement.
- When a customer interacts with a Microsoft support professional, we collect device and usage data or error reports to diagnose and resolve problems.
- When Microsoft sends communications to a customer, we use data to personalise the content of the communication.

The Enterprise and Developer Products enable our customers to purchase, subscribe to, or use other products and online services from Microsoft or third parties with different privacy practices. Those products and online services are governed by their respective privacy statements and policies.

Products provided by your organisation – notice to end users

If you use a Microsoft product with a work or school account, that organisation can:

- Control and administer your Microsoft product and product account, including controlling your access to, and the privacy-related settings of, the product or your account.
- Access and process your data, including the interaction data, diagnostic data, and the contents of your communications and files associated with your Microsoft product and accounts.

If your organisation provides you with access to Microsoft products, your use of those products is subject to your organisation's policies. For privacy questions or to exercise your data protection rights, please contact your organisation's administrator. Microsoft is not responsible for the privacy or security practices of our customers, including your work or school, which may differ from this privacy statement.

When you use a Microsoft product provided by your organisation, Microsoft processes your personal data as described in the contract with your organisation and as needed to provide the product and Microsoft's related business operations. For questions about Microsoft's processing of your data for your organisation, contact your organisation. If you have questions about Microsoft's business operations in connection with providing products to your organisation as provided in the Product Terms, contact Microsoft as described in the section.

For Microsoft products provided by your K-12 school, including Microsoft 365 Education, Microsoft will:

- not collect or use student personal data beyond that needed for authorised educational or school purposes;
- not sell or rent student personal data;
- not use or share student personal data for advertising or similar commercial purposes, such as providing personalised advertising to students;
- not build a personal profile of a student, other than for supporting authorised educational or school purposes or as authorised by the parent, guardian, or student of appropriate age; and
- require that our vendors who receive student personal data in order to provide our educational services to implement these same commitments for student personal data.

Back to top

Applicable Terms for Enterprise online services

To provide our Enterprise Online Services, Microsoft processes, uses, and stores data as described in the Product Terms, Microsoft Products and Services Data Protection Addendum (Products and Services DPA), and the Microsoft Trust Center.

Enterprise and developer software and enterprise appliances

Enterprise and developer software and enterprise appliances collect data to operate effectively and provide the best experiences. The types of data collected depend on the features you use and your organisation's configuration and settings but is generally limited to device and usage data. Customers and, where applicable, end users may have choices about the data provided. Examples include:

- Device and usage data collected during installation or upgrade to address technical issues.
- Device and usage data from product usage to improve security and functionality.
- Optional error reports sent to Microsoft to help diagnose problems and deliver support.

Microsoft uses this data to provide and improve our products, deliver customer support, activate products, communicate with users, and operate our business in compliance with applicable data protection laws.

HoloLens. HoloLens headsets are self-contained Windows computers with Wi-Fi connectivity that enable a mixed reality experience for apps and solutions. Microsoft collects diagnostic data to solve problems and to keep Windows running on HoloLens up to date, secure, and operating properly. Diagnostic data also helps us improve HoloLens and related Microsoft products and services depending on the diagnostic data settings you've chosen for your device. See the section for more information.

HoloLens also processes and collects data related to the HoloLens experience and device, which include cameras, microphones, and infrared sensors that enable motions and voice to navigate.

- If you choose, cameras can be used to sign you in automatically using your iris. To do this, HoloLens takes an image of your iris and measures distances between key points to create and store a numeric value that represents only you. This data stays on the HoloLens and is not shared with anyone, and you can choose to delete this data from your HoloLens at any time.
- HoloLens also detects hand gestures intended for system interactions (such as menu navigation, pan/zoom, and scroll). This data is processed on your HoloLens device and is not stored.
- HoloLens derives tracking points based on your environment which allows it to understand surfaces in space and allows you to place digital assets on them. There are no images associated with this environmental data and it is stored locally on the HoloLens device. You can choose to delete this data from your HoloLens at any time.

The headset's microphones enable voice commands for navigation, controlling apps, or to enter search terms. Learn more about voice data collection.

Productivity and communications products

Productivity and communications products are applications, software, and services like Microsoft 365, Microsoft Teams, OneDrive and others that you can use to create, store, and share documents, as well as communicate with others. These services will use your data depending on their features and how you use them – for example, we will collect usage data as well as information about your communications when you use Microsoft Teams, including the time and date and users that are part of the communication. Please see below for more details about these services, their features, and how they use data.

Microsoft 365, Office, and other productivity apps

Microsoft 365 is a collection of subscription productivity services and applications including Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, and OneNote, among others. Office is the one-time purchase version of these applications available on PC or Mac and includes Access and Publisher. Both Microsoft 365 and Office are comprised of client software applications and connected online services (or web apps in the case of Microsoft 365 for the web) that span many platforms and have numerous interdependent experiences. For more details about Outlook, see the Outlook section of this privacy statement.

You can manage your privacy by accessing the privacy controls within your Microsoft 365 and Office apps. For more information, see Account Privacy Settings.

Office Roaming Service. The Office Roaming Service helps keep your settings, including your privacy settings, up to date across your devices running Microsoft 365 or Office apps. When you sign in to your apps with either your Microsoft account or an account issued by your organisation, the service syncs some of your customised settings to Microsoft servers. When you sign in to another device with the same account, the Office Roaming Service downloads your settings from Microsoft servers and applies them to the additional device. When you sign out of your apps, the service removes your settings from your device. Any changes you make to your customised settings are sent to Microsoft servers.

Diagnostic Data. Diagnostic data is used to (i) keep your Microsoft 365 or Office apps secure and up to date; (ii) detect, diagnose, and remediate problems; and (iii) make product improvements. This data does not include a user's name or email address, the content of the user's files, or information about apps unrelated to Microsoft 365 or Office.

Please see the section and for more information.

Connected Experiences. Microsoft 365 and Office provide more experiences that are connected to and backed by cloud-based services.

Working with others on a document stored on OneDrive or translating the contents of a Word document into a different language are examples of connected experiences. There are two types of connected experiences.

- **Experiences that analyse your content**. Experiences that use your file content to provide you with design recommendations, editing suggestions, data insights, and similar features. For example, PowerPoint Designer or Editor in Word.

- **Experiences that download online content**. Experiences that allow you to search and download online content including templates, images, 3D models, videos, and reference materials to enhance your documents. For example, templates or PowerPoint QuickStarter.

If you choose to use connected experiences, we will collect required service data to help keep these connected experiences reliable, up to date, secure, and performing as expected.

Privacy controls within your Microsoft 365 and Office client apps allow you to configure your connected experiences. But even if you turn off connected experiences, certain functionality will remain available, such as syncing your mailbox in Outlook, as well as essential services described below. These controls are not available when using Microsoft 365 for the web since you will already be cloud-connected. For more information about accessing these controls, see Account Privacy Settings.

Essential services. There are a set of services that are essential to how Microsoft 365 and Office function and cannot be disabled. For example, the licensing service that confirms that you are properly licensed to use Microsoft 365 is essential. Required service data is collected and sent to Microsoft, regardless of any other settings that you have configured. See Essential Services for more information.

Required service data for connected experiences. As you use a connected experience, required service data necessary to deliver our cloud-based connected experiences is sent to and processed by Microsoft.

Required service data can include information related to the operation of the connected experience that is needed to keep the underlying service secure, up to date, and performing as expected. If you choose to use a connected experience that analyses your content – for example Translate in Word – the text you typed and selected to translate is also sent and processed to provide you with the connected experience. Your text and the translation are not stored by our service. See Required service data for more information.

Using device capabilities. Some Microsoft 365 applications make use of your device capabilities using certain features. In PowerPoint, for example, the presentation recording feature can access your device microphone and camera to record presentations with audio and video. Your device microphone is also accessed via the Record audio feature and when using Speaker Coach. When creating a PowerPoint presentation, you can also use the Screenshot and Screen clipping features to capture screen contents. When using the Screenshot feature in the Sticky Notes experience, you can capture content from the active window of other apps on your device and insert it into your note. You can then view, edit, and annotate the captured content within Sticky Notes. Some Microsoft 365 applications, including PowerPoint, Word, and OneNote, provide Dictate, a connected experience which lets you use speech-to-text to draft content using your microphone. In Word and OneNote, the Transcribe connected experience converts speech recorded directly in the app using your microphone or using a speech audio recording to a text transcript with each speaker individually separated. OneNote can also insert photos or record video using your camera. All Microsoft 365 apps along with To Do and Whiteboard have sharing functionality that accesses your contacts to allow you to share your documents with others in your contacts list. Applications will not access your device capabilities until you begin using the feature.

You can manage your microphone and camera access settings in the Windows Privacy Settings menu. Go to **Start > Settings > Privacy or Privacy & Security**. To learn more about how to control your privacy settings in apps, see Windows privacy settings that apps use.

Microsoft Family Safety

The Microsoft Family Safety M365 product allows a family group to connect through the Microsoft Family Safety app on their Windows, XBOX, or mobile devices. Please carefully review the information at Microsoft Family Safety if choosing to create or join a family group.

Microsoft Family Safety can help parents and guardians through tools such as digital content filtering, screen time limits, spending for Microsoft and XBOX stores, setting age limits for apps and games, and location sharing. To learn about how Microsoft collects and uses children's data, see the section of the Privacy Statement. If you are using Microsoft Family Safety in Windows, see the section of the Privacy Statement for more information.

To enable Family Safety controls on a child account, the child account must be part of a family group. Accounts that require parental consent to be created are automatically included as part of the family group of the individual who

consented to the child account's creation. For accounts that do not require parental consent to be created, the parent or guardian must add the account to their family group in order to use Family Safety controls.

When you have enabled family activity reporting for a child, Microsoft will collect details about how the child uses their devices, such as search, web, app, and game activity, and provide parents with reports of that child's online activities. Activity reports are routinely deleted from Microsoft servers.

Certain Family Safety features, such as Location Sharing, Drive Safety, Share Drives, Places, and Location Alerts, will use your location information when enabled. When you have enabled Location Sharing, for instance, your device will upload location data to the cloud and share it with others in your family group. Microsoft retains only your last known location as part of the Location Sharing feature. When you enable Drive Safety, your location will be used to record your driving habits, such as whether you are driving within the speed limits, if you're using your phone while driving, and if you accelerate or brake suddenly. These reports will be uploaded to the cloud, and you can choose to share your drive reports with your family group. You can turn off these location features at any time in the Family Safety settings. You can manage your device's location data on the Microsoft Privacy Dashboard. Learn more about Family Safety and your location data.

Microsoft Launcher

Microsoft Launcher is an Android app that offers a highly customisable app launcher experience on Android devices.

Microsoft Launcher lets you log in with your personal Microsoft account or work account or use it without any account. However, some functions may be limited if you do not grant certain permissions.

To use Microsoft Launcher, the application must be installed on your Android device, and permissions are required to enable the following features:

Microsoft Copilot. When signed in with your personal Microsoft account, you can seamlessly use Copilot features such as chat, web search, voice search and image search. Certain Copilot features require access to your device capabilities, such as your device camera, microphone, photos and videos. Please see our section for more information.

Glance. Glance helps you organise daily activities, such as Outlook calendar, To Do list, Sticky Notes and recent documents in your M365 apps. After signing-in with your personal Microsoft account or your work account, your data will be synced across devices signed into the same account to give you personalised experiences. It also lets you review recent activities, like recent photos and app usage, if you have given Glance permission to access that data.

News Feed. When you sign in with your Microsoft account, you can enjoy a personalised news feed and advertisements in Launcher's News Feed, synchronised across all your devices. You can also receive local curated news when you grant Microsoft Launcher permission to access your location information. You can manage your ad preferences through the Microsoft privacy dashboard.

Weather Notifications. Microsoft Launcher allows you to receive the latest weather information on your home screen with MSN Weather. You can receive up-to-date local weather information when you allow Launcher to access your location or provide your postcode.

Backup and Restore. Microsoft Launcher's backup and restore feature lets you easily transfer between phones or try different home screen setups. Backups can be stored locally on your device or saved to your OneDrive account associated with your Microsoft account for easy access.

Microsoft Launcher supports Android work profile features, enabling you to maintain a clear boundary between personal and work data on your device. This means you can securely access work resources without mixing them with your personal apps and data.

To learn more about Microsoft Launcher and its supported features, please visit .

Back to top

Microsoft Teams

This section applies to the consumer offering of Teams; if you are using Teams with a school or work account, see the Enterprise and developer products section of this privacy statement.

Teams is an all-in-one collaboration and communication hub. As part of providing Teams features, Microsoft collects usage data as well as information about your communications, including the time and date of the communication and users that are part of the communication. With your consent, you can share your location with friends and family.

Your Teams profile includes information you provided when you set up a Microsoft account, including your display name, email, and/or phone number. Your Teams profile information may become visible to other users through your interactions with them or through your use of other apps or services, including Loop. Microsoft may also share this information with enterprise customers when you interact through meetings and chats with end users who are using their school or work account. For instance, if you engage in a Teams chat with a user who is using Teams associated with their school account, Microsoft may share your information with that user's school as part of providing the Teams service.

Finding Teams contacts. To enable other people to find you on Teams (or products that interact with Teams for personal use, including Teams for enterprise), your Teams profile is included in the Teams public search directories, and may be displayed on Teams. Depending on your settings, Teams users can find you by your display name, email, and/or phone number. Your profile includes your username, profile photo, and any other data you choose to add to your profile or display to others. Your Teams profile may be visible to enterprise customers and their end users when you engage with an end user of an organisation in chats and meetings.

Syncing Teams contacts. With your permission, Teams will sync your device and Outlook contacts periodically and check for other Teams users that match contacts in your device or Outlook address books. If you choose to stop syncing your device or Outlook contacts, or if you are inactive on your device, any contacts that have not been matched during the synchronisation process will be deleted from Teams. If you wish to invite any of your device or Outlook contacts to join a conversation, you can invite users to a 1:1 directly, or Microsoft can send an invitation on your behalf via SMS or email for invitations to group conversations.

Notice to non-user contacts. If your information appears in the device or Outlook address books of a Teams user who chooses to sync their device or Outlook contacts with their Teams contacts, Microsoft may process your data in order to determine whether you are a current Teams user and to allow Teams users to invite you to the service, including via SMS and email. As long as the Teams user continues to be active on Teams on their device and continues to enable contact syncing with the applicable device or service, your information will be stored on our servers, and we will periodically process your information as a part of the Teams user's contact syncing experience to check whether you have subsequently joined Teams.

Learn more about contact sync in Teams.

If you do choose to join Teams, you will appear as a suggested new Teams contact for any Teams users with your information in their device or Outlook address books.

Third-party contacts. You can also choose to sync contacts from third-party providers. You can choose to unsync your third-party contacts on Teams or remove third-party contacts from all Microsoft apps and services. Please note that removing a third-party account from Teams may impact your experiences on other Microsoft apps and services that also use that account.

Teams calendar. You can also choose to sync your Teams calendar with calendars from third-party providers. You can stop syncing your Teams calendar anytime by removing a third-party account from Teams. If you have consented to use third-party data on other Microsoft apps and services, please note that removing this third-party account data in Teams may impact your experiences on other Microsoft apps and services.

Push notifications. Teams uses the notification service on your device to let you know of incoming calls, chats, and other messages. For many devices, these services are provided by another company. To tell you who is calling, for example, or to give you the first few words of the new chat, Teams has to tell the notification service so that they can provide the notification to you. The company providing the notification service on your device will use this information in accordance with their own terms and privacy policy. Microsoft is not responsible for the data collected by the company providing the notification service.

If you do not want to use the notification services for incoming Teams calls and messages, turn it off in the settings found on your device.

Chats and meetings with Enterprise customer end users. Many Microsoft products are intended for use by organisations, such as schools and businesses, as well as individual users. Please see the of this privacy statement if you are

using Teams with a work or school account. If you engage in Teams meetings or chats with end users of organisations, the data you share with the end users is subject to their organisation's policies, if any. You should direct your privacy enquiries related to your data shared through chats and meetings with an organisation's end users, including any requests to exercise your data protection rights, to the organisation's administrator. Microsoft is not responsible for the privacy or security practices of our customers, which may differ from those set forth in this privacy statement.

Microsoft Translator

Microsoft Translator is a machine translation system and service designed to automatically translate between numerous supported languages. Microsoft Translator is available as a stand-alone consumer app for Android, iOS, and Windows and is also integrated into a variety of Microsoft products and services, such as Translator Hub, Translator for Bing, and Translator for Microsoft Edge. Microsoft Translator processes the text, image, and voice data you submit, as well as device and usage data, to provide translations, personalise your experiences, and improve our products and services. Microsoft uses business and technical measures designed to help de-identify submitted data — such as deleting identifiers and certain text like email addresses and some number sequences that could contain personal data — when randomly sampling text and audio for product improvement. To learn more about how Microsoft manages your voice data, see Speech recognition technologies.

Separate Microsoft translation services are available as features in other Microsoft products and services that have different privacy practices than Microsoft Translator. For more information on the Microsoft Azure Cognitive Services Translator Text API, Custom Translator, and Translator Speech API, see the section of this privacy statement. For the Translate feature in Microsoft 365 apps, see the section of this privacy statement.

Back to top

OneDrive

OneDrive lets you store and access your files on virtually any device as well as share and collaborate on your files with others. Some versions of the OneDrive application enable you to access both your personal OneDrive (by signing in with your personal Microsoft account) and your OneDrive for Business (by signing in with your work or school Microsoft account).

When you use OneDrive, we collect data about your usage of the service, as well as the content you store, to provide, improve, and protect the services. For example, we index the contents of your OneDrive documents so that you can search for them later. We also collect device information so we can deliver personalised experiences, like enabling you to sync content across devices.

When you store content in OneDrive, your content will inherit the sharing permissions of the folder it's stored in. For example, if you store content in a public folder, the content will be public and available to anyone who can find the folder.

When you share content from your OneDrive account to a social network like Facebook, either your content is uploaded directly to that social network, or a link to that content is posted to that service. Doing this makes the content accessible to anyone on that social network. To delete the content, delete it from both the social network (if it was uploaded there) and from OneDrive.

When you share your OneDrive content with others via a link, an email with the link is sent to them, and allows anyone with the link to access your content. If one of the people who received the link sends it to other people, they will also be able to access your content, even if you did not choose to share the content with them. You can revoke access to your content on OneDrive by signing in to your account and then selecting the specific content to manage the permission levels. Once permissions are revoked, the link is deactivated and no longer usable unless you reshare it.

Files managed with OneDrive for Business are stored separately from files stored with your personal OneDrive. OneDrive for Business collects and transmits personal data for authentication, such as your email address and password, which will be transmitted to Microsoft and/or to the provider of your Microsoft 365 service.

Outlook

Outlook.com. Outlook.com is the primary consumer email service from Microsoft and includes email accounts with addresses that end in outlook.com, live.com, hotmail.com, and msn.com. Outlook.com provides features that let you connect with your friends on social networks. You will need to create a Microsoft account to use Outlook.com.

When you delete an email or item from a mailbox in Outlook.com, the item generally goes into your Deleted Items folder where it remains for approximately 7 days unless you move it back to your inbox, you empty the folder, or the service empties the folder automatically, whichever comes first. When the Deleted Items folder is emptied, those items remain in our system for up to 30 days before final deletion, unless we are legally required to retain the data for longer.

Outlook applications. Outlook client applications are software you install on your device that permits you to manage email, calendar items, files, contacts, and other data from email, file storage, and other services, like Exchange Online or Outlook.com, or servers, like Microsoft Exchange. You can use Outlook applications like the Outlook for Windows app across multiple accounts, even accounts from third-party providers. To add an account to your Outlook applications, you must provide permission for Outlook to access data from the email or file storage services.

When you add an account to Outlook, your emails, calendar, files, contacts, settings, and other data automatically sync to your device. On the mobile Outlook app, this data also syncs to Microsoft servers to enable enhanced features like improved search and personalised email filtering. On desktop, you can choose whether to sync your data to Microsoft servers. You can remove accounts or change sync settings at any time.

If you add a work or school account, your organisation can set rules and controls – like requiring multi-factor authentication or remotely erasing data on your device – that can affect how you use Outlook.

Using device capabilities. For Outlook clients that support it, you can use the Dictate feature to dictate the contents of and send an email. You can Dictate with your device's microphone or any other microphone you connect to your device. Outlook may also use your device location information to provide you with weather information for your current location as well as provide the ability to search for nearby locations.

To learn more about the data the Outlook applications collect and process, please see the Microsoft 365 section of this privacy statement.

Skype

The Skype Dial Pad allows you to make and receive calls to landlines or mobile numbers. This section applies to the consumer version of Skype; if you are using Skype for Business, see the section of this privacy statement.

As part of providing these features, Microsoft collects usage data about your calls, including the time and date and the numbers or user names that are part of the calls.

Compatibility with Teams. As a Skype user, you can also log into Teams using your Skype account. If you log into Teams via your Skype credentials, you can use Teams to chat with and call other Teams users. For more information about Teams, see the Microsoft Teams section of this privacy statement.

Emergency calling from the Skype Dial Pad in the United States. If you enable location sharing for emergency calling, your location will be periodically collected to enable Microsoft to share your location with emergency calling service providers if you dial 911. Your location information is only shared if you enable location sharing for emergency calling and you initiate a 911 call.

Surface

Microsoft offers its family of Surface devices and accessories to provide a great computing experience, including surfing the web, watching and streaming videos, playing games, running apps like Excel, Word, and OneNote, and more. These include devices and accessories like Surface Laptops, Surface Studios, Surface Book, Surface Pro, Surface Headphones, Surface Earbuds, Surface Dock, Surface Keyboard, and more.

Diagnostic data. Microsoft collects diagnostic data as you use your Surface devices, Surface accessories, and Surface applications. For more information, see the Diagnostic data section of this privacy statement, Diagnostic data for Surface products and Diagnostic data in the Surface app. For a list of Surface required diagnostic data collected, see Required diagnostic data for Surface products.

Surface Duo

Surface Duo supports mobile and WiFi connectivity and can be used for email, internet browsing, games, and business connectivity.

Microsoft provides a core Surface Duo experience that runs on the Google Android operating system. The core Surface Duo experience includes apps such as the Microsoft Launcher, Setup Wizard, and Your Phone Companion. You can sign in with a Google ID and enable various Google services; you can then also sign in with your Microsoft account and enable Microsoft services. Microsoft apps and services may rely on information provided by Google. Some features, such as location, require that you enable this functionality for Google and separately allow Microsoft to leverage this information.

Diagnostic data. Surface Duo collects diagnostic data to solve problems and to keep the core Surface Duo experience up to date, secure, and operating properly. This data also helps us improve Surface Duo and related Microsoft products and services. The data does not include your username, email address or the content of your files. See the section of this privacy statement for more information.

Learn more in Surface Duo Privacy Settings.

Surface Duo location settings. Surface Duo uses Google location services for determining your device's precise geographic location to provide you with enhanced experiences such as to show you your local weather. To allow Microsoft apps to access location-based features, you must enable location services for both Google and Microsoft . Some apps may require you to enable these settings separately within the Surface Duo's Settings. The provides details about Google's location service and related data privacy practices. See for more information.

SwiftKey

The Microsoft SwiftKey keyboard and related cloud-based services (collectively, "SwiftKey") process data about words you use and how you type. Microsoft uses this data to learn your writing style, and to provide personalised auto-correction and predictive text that adapts to you. We also use this data to offer a range of other features, such as emoji predictions.

SwiftKey prediction technology learns and reflects your writing style by analysing the words and phrases you use most often across various apps and websites creating a personalised language model to optimise text predictions. The keyboard avoids collecting sensitive information by excluding data from certain fields like passwords or payment details.

When you opt in to share with us, SwiftKey collects device and usage data and uses de-identified device data, usage data, and model data to analyse service performance and improve products. You can also choose to share your SwiftKey language and typing data to help improve Microsoft products and services. If you opt in, SwiftKey may send short, de-identified snippets of what and how you type, along with related correction data to our servers for processing. These text snippets are used in automated processes to validate prediction services and enhance product features. To protect your privacy, these snippets are never linked to your SwiftKey account. You can manage your choices at any time in SwiftKey Settings.

SwiftKey includes an optional OneDrive backup component. If you turn on backup and sync, SwiftKey saves your language model and related data to OneDrive, allowing you to use your personalised prediction synchronisation, additional services, and settings across all your devices. You must sign in with a Microsoft account to enable OneDrive backup and sync. Data in OneDrive is protected by OneDrive's security controls, including encryption in transit and at rest. You can turn backup off at any time in SwiftKey Settings and manage or delete SwiftKey data in your OneDrive.

When you use the camera feature in SwiftKey, you can choose to apply Augmented Reality (AR) effects to your selfies through third-party lens services. The lens feature processes your video and images to extract information about the location of your face and hands, solely for the purpose of transforming your appearance with AR effects. This session-based data is processed only on your device, is not used to personally identify you, is deleted immediately after use, and is never sent to SwiftKey or any third party.

Back to top

LinkedIn

To learn about the data LinkedIn collects and how it is used and shared, please see LinkedIn's Privacy Policy.

Search and browse

Search and browse products connect you with information and intelligently sense, process, and act on information—learning and adapting over time. For more information on artificial intelligence and Copilot capabilities in Microsoft's search and browse products, please see Artificial Intelligence and Microsoft Copilot capabilities above.

Bing

Bing services include search and mapping services, as well as other apps and programmes described in this section. Bing services collect and process data in many forms, including text that has been inked or typed, voice data, and images. Bing services are also included within other Microsoft services, such as Microsoft 365, and certain features in Windows – we refer to these as Bing-powered experiences.

When you conduct a search, or use a feature of a Bing-powered experience that involves you conducting a search or entering a command, we will use that data (which could take the form of text, voice data, or an image), along with your IP address, location, the unique identifiers contained in our cookies or similar technologies, the time and date of your search, and your browser configuration to complete the task you've requested. If you use Bing voice-enabled services, your voice input and the performance data associated with the speech functionality will be sent to Microsoft. Learn more about how we use and protect voice data in speech recognition technologies.

Copilot Search. Bing now includes an AI-enhanced web search functionality, Copilot Search, which supports users by reviewing and summarising search results from across the web, and sparking creativity by helping users create content. Copilot Search's use and collection of personal data is consistent with Bing's core web search offering as described in this section. Learn more about Copilot Search .

Search suggestions. The search suggestions feature allows us to provide you with relevant suggestions as you type your searches. To provide this feature, Microsoft collects the characters that you type and what you click on. To turn this feature on or off in Bing, go to Bing Settings. In the Microsoft Edge browser, go to Edge Settings to turn off search suggestions. Search suggestions cannot be turned off in the search box in Windows 10 and Windows 11.

Bing experience improvement programme for Bing Desktop and Bing Toolbar. If you are using Bing Desktop or Bing Toolbar and choose to participate in the Bing Experience Improvement Programme, we also collect additional data about how you use these specific Bing apps, including the addresses of the websites you visit, to help improve search ranking and relevance. We do not use the data collected through the Bing Experience Improvement Programme to identify or contact you or to personalise advertising. You can turn off the Bing Experience Improvement Programme at any time in the Bing Desktop or Bing Toolbar settings. We delete the information collected through the Bing Experience Improvement Programme after 18 months.

Personalisation through Microsoft account. Bing provides you with an enhanced experience when you sign in with your personal Microsoft account, including syncing your search history across devices, customising your interests, favourites, and settings, and connecting your account with third-party services. Visit Bing Settings to manage your personalisation settings.

Managing search history. When you're signed in with your personal Microsoft account, you can manage your Bing search history on the Microsoft privacy dashboard or through Bing Settings. These tools allow you to review and clear your search terms and clicked results from Bing. Clearing your history in Bing removes it from your search history, but does not delete information from our search logs, which are retained and de-identified as described above or based on your privacy dashboard instructions.

Third-party services that use Bing. You may also access Bing-powered experiences when using third-party services. In order to provide these services, Bing receives data from these and other partners, including your search query and related data (such as date, time, IP address, and a unique identifier). We will use this data as described in this statement or as further limited by our contractual obligations with our partners. Please refer to the privacy policies of the third-party services for any questions about how these third parties collect and use your data.

Data passed to destination website. When you select a search result or advertisement from a Bing search results page and go to the destination website, the destination website will receive the standard data your browser sends to every web site you visit—such as your IP address, browser type and language, and the host name of the site you came from.

Sharing data from Bing and Bing-powered experiences with third parties. We share some de-identified data from Bing and Bing-powered experiences with selected third parties. Before we do so, we run the data through a process designed to remove certain sensitive data that users may have included in the search terms themselves (such as social security numbers or credit card numbers). We require these third parties to keep the data secure and to not use the data for purposes other than for which it is provided.

Microsoft Edge

Microsoft Edge is the default web browser for Windows and is also available on other supported versions of Linux, macOS, iOS, and Android. Microsoft collects data that is necessary to provide features you request in Microsoft Edge. Data about how you use your browser, such as your browsing history, web form data, temporary internet files, and cookies, are stored on your device. Edge can also store your passwords on your device in Password Manager. You can delete this data from your device in Edge settings.

Keep in mind that whenever you use a web browser to access the internet, standard data about your device—like your IP address, browser type and language, access times, and referring website addresses—is sent to the websites you visit and online services you use. Those websites and services may log that data on their servers. Which data they log and how they use that data depends on the privacy practices of the websites you visit and web services you use.

Microsoft Edge collects diagnostic data to keep the service up to date, secure, and operating properly. You can also choose to send optional diagnostic data—including usage information, browsing history, information about websites you visit, and search terms—to help enhance Microsoft Edge and other Microsoft products and services. The diagnostic data collected by Microsoft Edge is stored with one or more unique identifiers that help us recognise an individual browser installation on a device and understand the browser's service issues and use patterns. Please see the section of the privacy statement for more.

When you allow it, Microsoft Edge collects and uses data from your search activity across the web, including websites Microsoft does not own or operate, to improve Microsoft services. This data may include your search queries, the search results and your interactions with those results (like the links you click), and demographic information that is part of the search results. Microsoft Edge de-identifies this data and retains it for one year. Microsoft does not use this collected data to personalise or provide ads to you. You can turn off this data collection in your Edge settings.

Syncing across devices. When you sign into Microsoft Edge using your Microsoft account, Microsoft Edge will store your privacy preferences and apply these settings across your signed-in devices, including during Windows device setup or when you sign into Microsoft Edge with your account on a new device.

Microsoft Edge can sync your browser data – including your favourites, browsing history, extensions and associated data, settings, open tabs, autofill form entries (like your name, address, and phone number), passwords, and payment information – across your signed in devices. You can control which data to sync in Edge settings. If you delete browser data while synced, you will delete the data across all signed-in devices. If you choose to sync extensions that you acquired from third-party web stores, a copy of those extensions will be downloaded directly to your synced device(s).

Personalisation. You may also choose to share your Microsoft Edge browsing activity with us to allow us to personalise Microsoft Edge and other Microsoft services like ads, Bing, Shopping, MSN, and Copilot. Browsing activity includes your browse history, favourites, usage data, and web content. You can stop sharing your Microsoft Edge browsing activity within Edge settings. The **See ads that interest you** setting on the Microsoft privacy dashboard lets you control the use of your browsing activity for personalised ads. For more information about our advertising practices, see the section of this privacy statement.

If you have turned on Microsoft's **Password Monitor**, your saved credentials are hashed, encrypted, and sent to the Password Monitor service so that we can warn you if your credentials were detected in a malicious attack or a breach. We do not retain this data after the check is complete.

Microsoft Edge's **Search and site suggestions** feature uses your search queries and browsing history to provide faster and more relevant browse recommendations. As you type in the address bar, Microsoft Edge sends your

search queries, standard device data, and location (if enabled) to your default search provider for real-time suggestions and search results. You can disable these features in Edge settings. If Bing is your default search provider, we use this data as described in the Bing section of this privacy statement.

Copilot in Edge collects and processes data in order to provide the services requested, including text that has been typed, voice data, and uploaded files. When using Copilot features in Microsoft Edge, you can choose to allow Microsoft Copilot in Edge to access your browsing activity, including screenshots of webpages you visit, open tabs, and browsing history to provide better answers and enable advanced Copilot features. You can manage Copilot in Edge choices in Edge settings. If you choose to use features that perform tasks on your behalf, Copilot will capture visual snapshots of the pages it visits to interact with and complete the action. Microsoft Edge's use of data connected with Copilot experiences is consistent with the Copilot data use described in the Artificial Intelligence and Microsoft Copilot capabilities section of this privacy statement.

Certain features in Microsoft Edge connect you to MSN content, such as when you open a new tab in the browser. Data use in MSN is covered by the MSN section of this privacy statement.

Learn more about Microsoft Edge, browsing data, and privacy.

Windows

Windows is a personalised computing environment that enables you to seamlessly roam and access services, preferences, and content across your computing devices. Key components of Windows are cloud-based, and both cloud and local elements of Windows are updated regularly, providing you with the latest improvements and features. To provide this computing experience, we collect data about you, your device, and the way you use Windows. And because Windows is personal to you, we give you choices about the personal data we collect and how we use it. If your Windows device is managed by your organisation, your organisation may use centralised management tools provided by Microsoft or others to access and process your data (including your interaction data, diagnostic data, and the contents of your communications and files), and to control device settings (including privacy settings), device policies, software updates, data collection by us or the organisation, or other aspects of your device.

Windows Settings, formerly known as PC Settings, is an essential component of Microsoft Windows, and offers a convenient interface for adjusting user preferences, configuring the operating system, and managing connected devices so that you can manage user accounts, adjust network settings, and personalise various aspects of Windows. Windows Settings also allows you to manage which apps can access various device capabilities such as the device's camera, microphone, location, calendar, contacts, call history, messages and more, while controlling access to your personal data. Each capability has its own privacy settings page in Windows Settings, so you can control which apps can use each capability.

Key features of Settings include:

1. Customisation: Personalise Windows appearance, language, and privacy settings, including using device features like the microphone, camera, and location.
2. Peripheral Management: Install and manage devices such as printers, monitors, and external drives.
3. Network Configuration: Adjust WiFi, Ethernet, mobile and VPN settings, using relevant device identifiers.
4. Account Management: Add or remove user accounts and manage sign-in options.
5. System-Level Options: Configure display, notifications, power, and manage installed apps and more.
6. Privacy & Security Management: Set privacy preferences such as location and collection of diagnostic data. Fine-tune which individual apps and services can access device capabilities by turning them on or off.

For more information about data collection in Windows, see Data collection summary for Windows. This statement discusses Windows 10 and Windows 11 and references to Windows in this section relate to those product versions. Earlier versions of Windows are subject to their own privacy statements.

Activation

When you activate Windows, a specific product key is associated with the device on which your software is installed. The product key and data about the software and your device are sent to Microsoft to help validate your licence to the software. This data may be sent again if there is a need to re-activate or validate

your licence. On phones running Windows, device and network identifiers, as well as device location at the time of the first power-up of the device, are also sent to Microsoft for the purpose of warranty registration, stock replenishment, and fraud prevention.

Advertising ID

Windows generates an advertising ID for each user on a device, which Microsoft, third-party apps, and advertising networks can use to provide relevant ads and personalised experiences on apps and across the web, similar to how websites use cookies. App developers and advertising networks can also use it for their own purposes, subject to their own privacy policies and the controls described below.

The advertising ID setting applies to Windows apps using the Windows advertising identifier. You can turn off use of the advertising ID in the Windows Settings app. Learn more about advertising ID in Windows.

The advertising ID setting does not apply to other methods of personalised advertising delivered by Microsoft or third parties, such as cookies used to provide personalised display ads on websites. Third-party products accessed through or installed on Windows may also deliver other forms of personalised advertising subject to their own privacy policies. For more information on how Microsoft uses data for advertising, see the and sections of this privacy statement.

Mobile plan activation from Mobile Operator website

When you seek to activate a mobile data plan from a third-party mobile operator for your Windows device through the Settings app in Windows, the mobile operator's website may request access to your device and SIM card identifiers. With your consent, the Settings app may share the specific identifiers with the operator's website.

Diagnostics

As we mention in the section above, Microsoft collects diagnostic data to solve problems and to keep its products like Windows up to date, secure, and operating properly, and to improve Windows and related Microsoft products and services. This data is periodically collected from your device and stored with unique identifiers to help Microsoft recognise individual users on a device and identify issues and usage patterns.

Certain product documentation and other materials refer to required diagnostic data as "Basic diagnostic data" and to optional diagnostic data as "Full diagnostic data." Please see the for more information about how Windows uses diagnostic data. For a current list of **required diagnostic data** and **optional diagnostic data** collected, see Windows Required (Basic level) diagnostic events and fields or Windows Optional (Full level) diagnostic data.

If you use a work or school account, your organisation may enrol your device in the Windows diagnostic data processor configuration. Microsoft processes Windows diagnostic data based on a contract with the organisation. If an organisation uses Microsoft management tools or engages Microsoft to manage your device, Microsoft and your organisation can process and use diagnostic and error data from your device for device management, monitoring, troubleshooting, and other organisational purposes.

Required diagnostic data includes information about your device, its settings and capabilities, and whether it is performing properly. We collect the following required diagnostic data:

- Device, connectivity, and configuration data:
  - Data about the device such as the processor type, OEM manufacturer, type of battery and capacity, number and type of cameras, firmware, and memory attributes.
  - Network capabilities and connection data such as the device's IP address, mobile network, and whether the device is connected to a free or paid network.
  - Data about the operating system and its configuration such as the OS version and build number, region and language settings, diagnostics data settings, and whether the device is part of the Windows Insider Programme.
  - Data about connected peripherals such as model, manufacturer, drivers, and compatibility data.
  - Data about the applications installed on the device such as application name, version, and publisher.

- Whether a device is ready for and can receive an update based on factors like low battery, limited disk space, or connectivity through a paid network.
- Whether updates complete successfully or fail.
- Data about the reliability of the diagnostics collection system itself.
- Basic error reporting, which is health data about the operating system and applications running on your device.

Optional diagnostic data includes more detailed information about your device and its settings, capabilities, and device health. When you choose to send optional diagnostic data, required diagnostic data will always be included, and we collect the following additional information:

- Additional data about the device, connectivity, and configuration, beyond that collected as part of required diagnostic data.
- Status and logging information about the health of operating system and other system components beyond that collected about the update and diagnostics systems under required diagnostic data.
- App activity, such as which programmes are launched on a device, how long they run, and how quickly they respond to input.
- Browser activity, including browsing history and search terms, in Microsoft Edge.
- Enhanced error reporting, including the memory state of the device when a system or app crash occurs (which may unintentionally contain user content, such as parts of a file you were using when the problem occurred).

Even if you choose to send us optional diagnostic data, some of the data described above might not be collected from your device. Microsoft minimises the amount of data it collects by collecting some of the data from only a subset of devices (sample). The Diagnostic Data Viewer tool shows if your device is part of a sample and what specific data is collected from your device. You can find download instructions for the Diagnostic Data Viewer tool in the Windows settings app under **Diagnostics & feedback**.

The specific data collected through Windows diagnostics may change as needed to address new issues or support recently released devices. For example, Microsoft may collect new types of data to troubleshoot performance problems or update devices. We provide limited portions of error report information to partners, like device manufacturers, solely to help them repair or improve their products and services, which work with Windows and other Microsoft products and services. We may also share aggregated, de-identified diagnostic data, such as general usage trends for Windows apps and features, with select third parties. Learn more about diagnostic data in Windows.

Inking and typing recognition. You can choose to help Microsoft improve inking and typing recognition by sending inking and typing diagnostic data. If enabled, Microsoft collects samples of what you type or write to enhance features like handwriting recognition, autocompletion, next word prediction, and spelling correction across languages. The collected data is divided into small samples and processed to remove information that could identify you or reconstruct the original content, such as unique identifiers, sequencing details, email addresses, and numeric values. Performance data, including text changes you make manually and words you add to the dictionary, is also included. Learn more about improving inking and typing in Windows.

Personalised offers

If you choose to turn on **Personalised offers**, we will use information about your device and how you use it, including Windows diagnostic data, in combination with your account info and data collected by other Microsoft products and services to offer you personalised tips, ads, and recommendations to enhance your Windows experiences. Personalised offers include suggestions on how to customise and optimise Windows, as well as ads and recommendations for Microsoft and third-party products and services, features, apps and hardware to enhance your Windows experiences. For example, Windows might tell you about new features to help you get the most out of your device. If you stream movies in your browser, Windows might recommend an app from the Microsoft Store that streams more efficiently. Or, if you are running out of space on your hard drive, Windows might recommend you try OneDrive or purchase hardware to add more storage.

When Personalised offers is on, Windows may use your required diagnostic data to personalise offers. This data may include information about your device, its settings and capabilities, and whether it is performing properly. If you have decided to share optional diagnostic data, the data used to personalise offers may also include information about how you use apps and features, plus additional information about the health of your device. We may also use information about your device and your activity to personalise offers locally on

your device, even when the data does not leave your device. We do not use the content of crash dumps, speech, typing or inking input data for personalising offers.

In addition to information about your device and how you use it, including Windows diagnostic data, we may use or combine the following data from other Microsoft products and your account with Windows diagnostic data to personalise offers:

- Web activity, if you give Microsoft Edge permission to collect your web activity for personalised search, ads and news.
- Info about your use of other Microsoft products and services, including Microsoft Bing, Microsoft 365, XBOX, and Microsoft websites, such as MSN.com.
- Subscription and purchase history.
- Data from third-party websites which may be shared with Microsoft.

We may also use information about your interactions with tips, recommendations and promotions to provide and improve the personalised offers and similar messages in other Microsoft products.

To manage how data collected by other Microsoft products is used to personalise offers, you can visit your . In some regions such as the European Economic Area, turning off Personalised offers on Windows also stops the use of data from other Microsoft products to personalise tips, ads and recommendations in Windows. In other regions, you can manage how data collected by other Microsoft products is used to personalise offers by visiting your .

Contextual data from your device and some basic account data are used to show you appropriate messaging in Windows regardless of whether the Personalised offers setting in Windows or the settings to use data from other Microsoft products to personalise offers are turned off. For example, this data is used to make sure content is in the correct language and appropriate for your age group.

Personalised offers applies to tips, offers, ads and recommendations you see in Windows. Changing this setting will not impact the kinds of offers you may see in other Microsoft products. You can change this setting at any time by searching for **Personalised offers** in the Windows Settings app. .

Tailored experiences

Tailored experiences is being replaced by Personalised offers in more recent versions of Windows. If you have not installed the latest Windows Update, you may still see Tailored experiences on your device.

If you choose to turn on Tailored experiences, we will use your Windows diagnostic data (Required or Optional as you have selected) to offer you personalised tips, ads and recommendations to enhance Microsoft experiences. If you have selected Required as your diagnostic data setting, personalisation is based on information about your device, its settings and capabilities and whether it is performing properly. If you have selected Optional, personalisation is also based on information about how you use apps and features, plus additional information about the health of your device. However, we do not use information about the websites you browse, the content of crash dumps, speech, typing or inking input data for personalisation when we receive such data from customers who have selected Optional. Tailored experiences data is transmitted to Microsoft and stored with one or more unique identifiers that can help us recognise an individual user on an individual device and understand the device's service issues and use patterns.

Tailored experiences include suggestions on how to customise and optimise Windows, as well as ads and recommendations for Microsoft and third-party products and services, features, apps and hardware for your Windows experiences. For example, to help you get the most out of your device, we may tell you about features you may not know about or that are new. If you are having a problem with your Windows device, you may be offered a solution. You may be offered a chance to customise your lock screen with pictures, or to be shown more pictures of the kind you like, or fewer of the ones you do not. If you stream movies in your browser, you may be recommended an app from the Microsoft Store that streams more efficiently. Or, if you are running out of space on your hard drive, Windows may recommend you try OneDrive or purchase hardware to gain more space. .

Feedback Hub

Feedback Hub gives you a way to provide feedback on Microsoft products and installed first-party apps and in some cases third-party apps. It determines the apps installed on your device through public APIs. For HoloLens users, Feedback Hub can access your camera and microphone when you choose to share surroundings or audio input and uses your picture and document libraries to attach screenshots and screen recordings for feedback submissions.

You can sign into Feedback Hub with either your personal Microsoft account or a work or school account. When you use a work or school account your feedback may be associated with your organisation and viewable by its administrators through Feedback Hub or the admin centre. Regardless of which account you use, your feedback may be publicly accessible depending on your organisation's settings.

When you submit feedback about a problem to Microsoft, diagnostic data is sent to help improve Microsoft products and services. The Feedback Hub will either send this data automatically or give you the option to send it, depending on your diagnostic data settings in the **Diagnostics & feedback** section of Windows settings. Additional personal data may be collected based on the type of feedback you provide to better troubleshoot specific issues – for example, location data when providing feedback about location services. Microsoft may also share your feedback and related data with partners, like device manufacturers or firmware developers to assist in resolving issues with products and services that work with Windows. Learn more about diagnostic data in Windows.

Get Help

Get Help enables Windows users to get technical support on Windows and other Microsoft applications. It provides you with self-service support (such as links to help articles or directions on how you can solve problems on your own), recommends Diagnostics, and helps connect you to a live Microsoft agent if needed. If you choose to run a Diagnostic, any diagnostic data collected is handled according to the **Windows Diagnostics** section above. You can sign in with your Microsoft account to create a support case, and enterprise account users may also be able to do the same based on their organisation's support contract and administrator settings.

If enabled by system settings, you can use the system microphone in Get Help to voice your support question instead of typing, with controls available in the "Microphone Privacy Settings" in the Windows Settings app. Get Help does not use your location for its services.

Live captions

Live captions transcribe audio to help with the comprehension of spoken content. Live captions can generate captions from any audio containing speech, whether the audio is online, downloaded to your device, or received from your microphone. By default, transcribing microphone audio is disabled.

Voice data that is captioned is only processed on your device and is not shared to the cloud or with Microsoft. Learn more about live captions.

Location services

Windows location service. Microsoft's location service helps determine the precise geographic location of your Windows device using a combination of GPS, nearby wireless access points and routers, cell towers, IP address, or default location.

Location services give you control over which apps are allowed to access your precise location. When location services are turned off, Windows and apps will not have access to device location, and some apps may not be able to access information about Wi-Fi networks. With location services turned on, apps can access approximate location and can request permission to use precise location. You can manage these permissions in Windows Settings. When location is enabled, data about cell towers and Wi-Fi access points and their locations are collected, de-identified, and used to improve location services. Learn more about location in Windows.

If an app or feature accesses your device's location and you are signed in with your Microsoft account, your last known location information is also saved to the cloud. This information is available across your devices to other apps or services that use your Microsoft account and to which you've granted permission. This location information can be viewed or deleted from your Microsoft account privacy dashboard.

There are some exceptions to how your device's location can be determined that are not directly managed by the location settings. For example, desktop apps are a type of app that do not support per-app control over precise location access. Desktop apps are usually downloaded from the internet or installed from media (such as a CD, DVD, or USB storage device).

Even when you've turned off location services in Windows, some third-party apps and services could use other technologies (such as Bluetooth, IP address, mobile modem, etc.) or cloud-based location services to determine your device's location with varying degrees of accuracy.

To facilitate getting help in an emergency, whenever you make an emergency call, Windows will attempt to determine and share your precise location, regardless of your location settings. In addition, your mobile operator will have access to your device's location if your device is using a mobile service.

General location. If you turn on Location services in Windows Settings, apps that cannot use your precise location may still have access to your general or coarse location, such as your city, postcode, or region.

A limited set of features in Windows will use your IP address to provide you with contextual information for your area if location services are turned off, such as weather on the taskbar. For information about certain Windows apps that use the device's location, see the section of this privacy statement.

Find my device. The Find my device feature allows an administrator of a Windows device to find the location of that device from account.microsoft.com/devices. To enable Find my device, an administrator needs to be signed in with a Microsoft account and have the location setting enabled. This feature will work even if other users have denied access to location for all their apps. When the administrator attempts to locate the device, users will see a notification in the notification area. Learn more about Find my device in Windows.

Narrator

Narrator is a built-in Windows screen reader that enables you to navigate your device without a screen. When you use features such as image descriptions or page title descriptions (by pressing Narrator + Ctrl + D), or popular links lists (Narrator + double press of S), the image or URL of the web page you're visiting is sent to Microsoft. This data is used only to generate the requested descriptions or summaries and to improve Microsoft services, such as Bing. Images are not retained by Microsoft after analysis.

You can disable these features at any time by going to **Narrator>Get image descriptions, page titles and popular links** in Settings in Windows.

You can also send feedback about Narrator to help Microsoft diagnose and resolve problems with Narrator and improve Microsoft products and services, such as Windows. Verbal feedback can be submitted at any time in Narrator by using Narrator Key + Alt + F. The Feedback Hub app will launch when you use this command and give you the opportunity to submit verbal feedback. If you enable the setting "Help Make Narrator Better" in the Windows settings app and submit verbal feedback through Feedback Hub, recent device and usage data, including event trace log (ETL) data, will be submitted along with your verbal feedback to improve Microsoft products and services, such as Windows.

Linked mobile experiences on Windows

The Phone Link feature lets you link your mobile phone to your Windows PC, enabling a variety of cross-device experiences across all your Windows devices.

Some Phone Link features, and the resulting data that is synced between your phone and Windows devices, differs for Android devices and iPhones and is described separately below.

As part of providing Phone Link's features, Microsoft collects performance, usage, and device data that includes, for example, the hardware capabilities of your device and Windows device, the number and duration of your sessions on Phone Link, and the amount of time you spent during setup.

Android Devices

You can use Phone Link to see recent photos, view and send text messages, and make and receive live calls from your Android phone on your Windows device. You can also view, dismiss, or perform other actions to your Android phone notifications and instantly access and use Android apps installed on your Android phone from your Windows device and share your phone screen on your Windows device through Phone Link's mirroring function.

To use Phone Link, you must install the Link to Windows app on your Android device and grant the requested app permissions. You must log into your Microsoft account on the Phone Link feature on your Windows device and on Link to Windows on your Android phone. Both devices must be connected to the internet. Some features require Bluetooth and pairing your phone with your PC.

We never store your texts, call history, photos, or what apps you have or information displayed by the apps on our servers or change them on your phone.

You can unlink your Android phone from your Windows device at any time by going into your Phone Link settings and choosing to remove your Android phone, or from the settings in Link to Windows on your Android phone. For detailed information, see our support page.

Text Messages. Phone Link allows you to view text messages delivered to your Android phone on your Windows device and send text messages from your Windows device. Phone Link accesses the content of your text messages and the sender's or recipient's contact information. These text messages are temporarily stored on your device and only those messages received and sent within the last 30 days are visible on your Windows device.

Calls. Phone Link allows you to make, receive, and view your recent calls from your Android phone on your Windows device. To activate this feature, you must enable certain permissions on both the Phone Link Settings page on your Windows device and Android phone's settings, such as call logs access and permission to make phone calls from your PC. These call details are temporarily stored on your Windows device and only calls received and dialled within the last 30 days are visible under call logs on your Windows device.

Photos. Phone Link allows you to copy, share, edit, save, or delete a limited number of your most recent photos from your Android phone on your Windows device. These photos are temporarily stored on your Windows device.

Notifications. Phone Link allows you to view, read, dismiss, or perform other actions related to your Android phone's notifications on your Windows device. To activate this Phone Link feature, you must enable certain permissions, such as sync notifications, on both your Windows device and Android phone.

Apps mirroring. On supported devices, Phone Link allows you to use the Android apps that are installed on your Android phone on your Windows device. Microsoft collects a list of your installed Android apps and recent activity to provide the service and show you your most recently used apps but does not retain further information.

Instant Hotspot. On supported Android devices, Link to Windows enables users to share mobile hotspot information with their paired PC over secure Bluetooth communication. Your PC can then be connected to the internet. Please note mobile data charges may apply depending on your mobile data plan.

Contacts. Link to Windows allows you to sync your Android contacts into the Microsoft cloud. You can access them in other Microsoft products and services by going into Link to Windows settings and enabling "Contacts sync" feature. Your contacts information is stored online and associated with your Microsoft account. Learn more.

iPhones

You can use Phone Link to make and receive calls from your iPhone, view and send text messages, and view, dismiss, or perform other actions on your iPhone notification from your Windows device.

To use Phone Link, you must have Bluetooth enabled on your iPhone. You may also optionally install the Link to Windows app on your iPhone.

You can unlink your iPhone from your Windows device at any time by going into Phone Link settings and choosing to remove your iPhone. You can do the same from your iPhone by going into **Settings > Bluetooth > Selecting your PC name > click on the (i) icon > and choosing Forget This Device**.

We never store your texts or call history on our servers or change them on your iPhone.

Text Messages. Phone Link allows you to view text (SMS) messages delivered to your iPhone on your Windows devices and send text messages from your Windows device. Phone Link accesses the content of your text messages and the sender's or recipient's contact information. These text messages are temporarily stored on your Windows device and only text messages received and sent within your Bluetooth session or iMessage are visible on your Windows devices.

Calls. Phone Link allows you to make, receive, and view your recent calls from your iPhone on your Windows device. To activate this feature, you must enable the Sync Contacts feature under Bluetooth settings on your iPhone. These call

details are temporarily stored on your Windows device.

Notifications. Phone Link allows you to view, read, dismiss, or perform other actions related to your iPhone's notifications on your Windows device. To activate this Phone Link feature, you must enable certain permissions such as sync notifications, on both your Windows device and iPhone.

Contacts. Phone Link allows you to sync your contacts from your iPhone to access them for messaging and calling by going into Bluetooth settings on your iPhone and toggle on Sync Contacts under your PC name after connecting your iPhone to Phone Link.

Cross-device experiences

Cross-device experiences in Windows enable access to a linked mobile device from your PC through your Microsoft account. By linking your mobile device and enabling these experiences, Windows may make certain mobile device content available across Windows to deliver features and services that support integrated cross-device functionality. These can be managed under "Mobile Devices" in the Bluetooth & Devices section in your Windows PC Settings. As part of providing these features, Microsoft collects performance usage and device data, including information about the hardware capabilities of your mobile and Windows devices. You can turn this feature on or off at any time in your Windows PC Settings.

Use your mobile device as a connected camera. This feature allows you to use your mobile device's camera in apps or products on Windows that support camera functionality. You can enable this feature under "Mobile Devices" in the Bluetooth & Devices section in the Settings on your PC. Microsoft does not record or store your camera sessions or any of the information displayed by your camera in any of the applications or products.

Get new photo notifications from your mobile device. This feature allows you to receive notifications from your linked mobile device on your Windows PC. These photos are temporarily stored on your Windows PC while you are editing or opening those photos. You will need to initiate saving to your PC to store those photos until you decide to delete them. We never store your photos on our servers or change or delete any photos on your mobile device.

Show your mobile device in File Explorer and device name in Windows Share. This feature allows you to access your mobile device's files in File Explorer. You can enable this feature under "Mobile Devices" in the Bluetooth & Devices section in the Settings on your PC. Microsoft will not store your file contents in its services.

You can also enable access to your linked mobile device through Windows Share. You can turn on this feature in Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Mobile devices. Once enabled, your linked devices are visible in Windows, allowing you to share files and folders between your PC and your mobile device.

Recording

Some Windows devices have a recording feature that allows you to capture audio and video clips of your activity on the device, including your communications with others. If you choose to record a session, the recording will be saved locally on your device. In some cases, you may have the option to transmit the recording to a Microsoft product or service that broadcasts the recording publicly. **Important: You should understand your legal responsibilities before recording and/or transmitting any communication. This may include obtaining the prior consent of everyone participating in the conversation or any other authorisations as required**. Microsoft is not responsible for how you use recording features or your recordings.

Back to top

Security and safety features

Device encryption. Device encryption helps protect the data stored on your device by encrypting it using BitLocker Drive Encryption technology. When device encryption is on, Windows encrypts the drive Windows is installed on and generates a recovery key. The BitLocker recovery key for your personal device is automatically backed up online and associated with your personal Microsoft account. Microsoft doesn't use your individual recovery keys for any purpose.

Malicious Software Removal Tool (MSRT). MSRT runs on your device at least once per month as part of Windows Update, and checks for infections by specific, prevalent malicious software ("malware") and helps remove any infections found. When MSRT runs, it will remove the malware listed on the

Microsoft Support website if the malware is on your device. During a malware check, a report will be sent to Microsoft with specific data about malware detected, errors, and other data about your device. You can turn off MSRT's reporting feature if you do not want to send this data to Microsoft.

Microsoft Family. Parents can use Microsoft Family Safety to understand and set boundaries on how their child is using their device. Please carefully review the information at Microsoft Family Safety if choosing to create or join a family group. For users under the age of 13, or as specified by law in their jurisdiction, certain Microsoft products and services will either block users under that age or will ask them to obtain consent or authorisation from a parent or guardian before they can use it, including when creating an account to access Microsoft services. If you are under the statutory age in your region, during the registration process you'll be prompted to request consent from a parent or guardian by entering an adult's email. When Family activity reporting is turned on for a child, Microsoft will collect details about how the child uses their device and provide parents with reports of that child's activities. Activity reports are routinely deleted from Microsoft servers.

Microsoft Defender SmartScreen and Smart App Control. Microsoft strives to help protect your device and passwords from unsafe apps, files, and web content.

Microsoft Defender SmartScreen helps protect you and your device by identifying threats from unsafe websites, apps, and files. When checking content, it sends relevant data—including web addresses and, if needed, details about suspicious sites or apps—to Microsoft for security analysis. This data will only be used for security purposes in detecting, protecting against, and responding to security incidents, identity theft, fraud, or other malicious, deceptive, or illegal activities. If a threat is found, you'll receive a warning instead of the content. You can turn this feature on or off in the Windows Security app.

Where supported, Smart App Control checks software installed on your device to identify potential threats. On supported devices, it begins in evaluation mode using data collected by Microsoft Defender SmartScreen—such as file names, hashes, download locations, and digital certificates—to determine if Smart App Control is suitable for your device. If your device qualifies, Smart App Control is automatically enabled for added protection; otherwise, it remains permanently off. For unsupported or unsuitable devices, Microsoft Defender SmartScreen continues to provide protection. When Smart App Control is active, it blocks and alerts you about apps identified as malicious, potentially unwanted, or unknown and unsigned before they open, run or install. Learn more about Smart App Control.

When either Microsoft Defender SmartScreen or Smart App Control checks a file, data about that file is sent to Microsoft, including the file name, a hash of the file's contents, the download location, and the file's digital certificates. You can turn Smart App Control on or off in the Windows Security app.

Microsoft Defender Antivirus. Microsoft Defender Antivirus automatically activates to protect your device when no other antimalware software is running and monitors your device's security status and scans for malware, unwanted software, and potentially harmful apps. When Microsoft Defender Antivirus is turned on or otherwise running, it automatically sends reports to Microsoft with data about suspected malware and other unwanted software, potentially unwanted apps, and other malicious content. It may also send files that could contain malicious content, such as malware or unknown files for further inspection. If a report may contain personal data, you'll be asked for permission before it's sent. You can choose to disable reporting and file sharing with Microsoft.

Speech, Voice Activation, Inking, and Typing

Speech. Microsoft provides both a device-based speech recognition feature and cloud-based (online) speech recognition technologies.

Turning on the Online speech recognition setting lets apps use Microsoft cloud-based speech recognition. Additionally, in Windows 10, the Online speech recognition setting enables your ability to use dictation within Windows.

Turning on speech while setting up a HoloLens device or installing Windows Mixed Reality allows you to use your voice for commands, dictation, and app interactions. Both device-based speech recognition and online speech recognition settings will be enabled. With both settings enabled, while your headset is turned on the device will always be listening to your voice input and will send your voice data to Microsoft's cloud-based speech recognition technologies.

When you use our cloud-based speech recognition technologies, we collect and use your voice recordings and create a text transcription of the spoken words in the voice data. Microsoft will not store, sample, or listen to your voice recordings without your permission. .

You can turn off online speech recognition at any time and stop any apps that rely on the online speech recognition setting from sending your voice data to Microsoft. You can still use device-based speech recognition services that do not rely on the cloud and only use device-based recognition—like captions, Narrator, or voice access—without sending your voice data to Microsoft. However, Microsoft cloud-based speech recognition technologies provide more accurate recognition than the device-based speech recognition.

If you are using a HoloLens or Windows Mixed Reality headset, you can also turn off device-based speech recognition at any time. This will stop the device from listening for your voice input. .

Voice activation. Windows provides supported apps with the ability to respond and take action based on voice keywords that are specific to that app.

If you've given permission for an app to listen for voice keywords, Windows will actively monitor the microphone for those keywords. Each app needs to ask for your permission before accessing your microphone. When a keyword is detected, the app will access and process your voice recording, take action, and respond, such as with a spoken answer. The app may send your voice recording to its own cloud services to process commands and collect the recordings for other purposes, such as improving its services.

Voice activation functionality can be enabled when the device is locked and the screen is off. Once an app is activated with a voice keyword, it may continue listening to the microphone. The app may be activated by anyone who speaks near the device and have access to the same set of capabilities and information as when the device is unlocked.

You can turn off voice activation at any time. Learn more about voice activation in Windows.

Even when you've turned off voice activation, some third-party desktop apps and services could still be listening to the microphone and collect your voice input. Learn more about third-party desktop apps and how they may still be able to access your microphone even with these settings turned off.

Voice typing. In Windows 11, dictation is now voice typing. Voice typing may use both device-based and online speech recognition technologies to power its speech-to-text transcription service. You can also choose to contribute voice clips to help improve voice typing. If you choose not to contribute voice clips, you can still use voice typing. You can change your selection anytime in the voice typing settings. Microsoft will not store, sample, or listen to your voice recordings without your permission. Learn more about Microsoft and your voice data.

Voice access. Windows enables everyone, including people with mobility disabilities, to control their PC and author text using their voice. For example, voice access supports scenarios such as opening and switching between apps, browsing the web and reading and authoring email. Voice access leverages modern, on-device speech recognition to accurately recognise speech and is supported without an internet connection. When a user invokes voice access it uses the device microphone. .

Inking & Typing Personalisation. Your typed and handwritten words are collected to provide you with a custom word list, better character recognition to help you type and write on your device and text suggestions that appear as you type or write.

You can turn off inking & typing personalisation at any time. This will delete your custom word list stored on your device. If you turn it back on, you'll need to recreate your custom word list. Learn more about inking & typing personalisation in Windows.

Sync and backup settings

When you sign into Windows with your Microsoft account, Windows can store your settings, files, and device configuration data in Microsoft's servers. Windows will only use the stored settings, files, and device configuration data to make it easier for you to migrate your experience on a different device.

You can turn off this feature and stop Windows from storing your settings, files, and configuration data from the Windows settings. You can delete the data that has been backed up previously to your Microsoft account, by visiting your Microsoft Account Devices page.

.

Update Services

Update Services for Windows includes Windows Update and Microsoft Update. Windows Update is a service that provides you with software updates for Windows software and other supporting software, such as drivers and firmware supplied by device manufacturers. Microsoft Update is a service that provides you with software updates for other Microsoft software such as Microsoft 365.

Windows Update automatically downloads Windows software updates to your device. You can configure Windows Update to automatically install these updates as they become available (recommended) or have Windows notify you when a restart is required to finish installing updates. Apps available through the Microsoft Store are automatically updated through the Microsoft Store, as described in the Microsoft Store section of this privacy statement.

Windows AI Features

Click to Do

Click to Do can operate as a stand-alone feature or in partnership with Windows Recall. Once started, Click to Do enables you to capture and analyse screenshots, identify the presence of text and images, and offers relevant actions for each – such as editing a screenshot or revising captured text. Click to Do cannot identify the content within screenshots, but you can use local AI or other tools to modify that content if you wish. All activity remains on your local device unless you explicitly choose, like sending an image for a Bing search, requesting a summary of selected text (which is processed by Microsoft's Azure AI cloud service), or using another tool to modify a screenshot.

Additionally, Click to Do allows you to use your microphone to search for text within a captured screenshot: when you click the microphone button, it listens to what's said, enters it into the Search box, and highlights all matching results. The audio captured by the microphone is not transmitted off your device.

Windows Recall

Recall is a Windows feature available exclusively on Copilot+ PCs that helps users find previously viewed content using remembered text or visual clues. To use Recall, users must opt-in to save snapshots — screen images with metadata like app name and time stamp — which are securely stored locally and protected with Windows Hello Enhanced Sign-in Security (ESS). Each time Recall is opened, users must authenticate using Windows Hello biometric sign-in or PIN to decrypt snapshot contents. Analysis and processing of snapshots occur only on the device. Click to Do runs on top of snapshots in Recall to help you to take actions with your images or text on the screen.

Recall lets you search for text within captured snapshots using your Copilot+ PC's microphone. When you click on the microphone button inside the Search box within the Recall window, it enters what you said in the Search box. The microphone remains active until you pause your speech, and all audio captured stays on your device.

Recall securely stores all captured data – including personal data like snapshots, metadata, processing results, and user queries – locally on your Copilot+ PC and within your signed-in account. This information is never transmitted off your device unless you take action, such as copying a snapshot to another app or submitting feedback through the Windows Feedback Hub with a snapshot attached. The only way Recall content can be shared is by explicit user action on the device.

You can control your content (such as snapshots, metadata, search queries, and history) by pausing or deleting snapshots, filtering content, or using a supported browser in privacy mode. Learn more about your privacy and control over your Recall experience.

In addition to the Recall search feature, Recall also has a timeline feature that organises snapshots chronologically in a timeline, displayed via a horizontal scrollbar, making it easy to review and utilise your past PC activities. Within the timeline view, you can delete snapshots individually, by website domain, or by app.

Recall also has a Sensitive Content filter that is on by default to help prevent the retention of information that might be more delicate in nature (e.g., credit card numbers, state issued ID numbers, etc.). Users can turn this filter off if they wish in Windows Settings.

Windows apps

A number of Microsoft apps are included with Windows and others are available in Microsoft Store. Please visit Microsoft Store to learn more about each of these apps, including:

Camera app. If you allow the Camera app to use your location, location data is embedded in the photos and videos you take with your device. Other descriptive data, such as camera model and the date that the picture or video was taken, is also embedded in photos and videos. If you choose to share a photo or video, any embedded data will be accessible to the people and services you share with. Once enabled, you can always disable the Camera app's access to your location by turning off all access to the location service in your device's Settings menu or turning off the Camera app's access to the location service.

When the Camera app is open, it shows rectangles detected by the selected camera for areas in the image that are potentially used for image enhancement. The Camera app does not retain any image enhancing data. You can always change your camera access settings in the Windows Settings menu. The Camera app uses various device capabilities such as location, camera, microphone, video, and picture library.

Photos app. There are two versions of the Photos app available. The updated Photos app includes features like iCloud integration and local and cloud folder views. The previous legacy version of the Photos app includes features like Video Editor, the People tab, and Albums. You are using the updated Photos app if the "About" section in the Photos app settings indicates the app is the "Updated" Photos app.

The updated Photos app lets you organise, view, and share photos and videos by grouping them through options such as name, date taken or modified, and storage location, whether locally or synced from cloud services like OneDrive and iCloud. You can move, copy, or upload files to your computer or OneDrive, and quickly access all photos by date, favourites, folders, and cloud service tabs for easy navigation and management.

The Photos legacy app lets you organise, view, and share your photos and videos, offering features not available in the updated Photos app, such as Collections, Albums, Video Editor, and the People setting. Collections display photos and videos by date taken. Albums help organise by location and tags and the Video Editor provides tools for editing, creating, and sharing videos.

The People setting in the Photos legacy app, when enabled, uses face grouping technology to organise your local photos and videos by detecting faces and grouping visually similar ones. You can associate these facial groupings with contacts from your People app. You can enable this feature either from the Settings page or the People tab.

When People settings are enabled in the legacy app, your groupings will be stored on your device for as long as you keep groupings, or the related photos or videos themselves. If you haven't interacted with the Photos legacy app for three years, you'll be prompted to allow continued facial grouping.
You can turn the People setting on or off at any time in the Settings page; turning it off removes facial grouping data from the app but does not delete your photos or videos. Learn more about the Photos legacy app and facial grouping.

If you choose to share a photo or video using the Photos app or the Photos legacy app, any embedded data (such as location, camera model, and date) will be accessible to the people and services you share the photo or video with.

People app. The People app centralises your contacts in one place by automatically importing them when you add accounts, including email and social network accounts. When you add an account, we tell you what data the People app can import or sync with the particular service and let you choose what you want to add. Other apps you install may also sync data to the People app, including providing additional details to existing contacts. When viewing a contact, recent interactions such as emails and calendar events from synced apps are displayed. You can remove accounts from the People app at any time.

Mail and Calendar app. The Mail and Calendar app allows you to connect all your email, calendars and files in one place, including those from third-party email and file storage providers. When you add an account to the Mail and Calendar app, your email, calendar items, files, contacts, and other settings from your account will automatically sync to your device and to Microsoft servers. To configure an account, you must provide the app with your account credentials (such as username and password), which will be sent to the third-party provider's server. If your account is provided by an organisation (like a work account), the account owner can implement certain policies and controls that may affect your use of the app – for example, multi-factor authentication or the ability to remotely wipe data from your device. The app also provides location-based services, such as weather information in your calendar. You can remove an account, make changes to the data that's synced from your account, or disable access to your device's capabilities like your location and camera at any time.

Windows operator messages (previously Microsoft Messaging) app. The Windows Operator Messages app receives and shows account-related SMS texts from your mobile operator about your data plan (such as your billing and data limits) on your PC or device. These messages are stored locally on your device. From your device, you can also access, view, and delete these messages. This app uses your device capabilities such as Contacts.

The Clock app. The Clock app is your hub for time management and focus on Windows. When users sign in with their Microsoft account, they can enable Microsoft To Do, a cloud connected experience. When the user turns on Focus Session in Microsoft To Do, session data is stored locally, which you can clear by going to the Clock settings page. Additionally, Focus Sessions supports connecting to Spotify accounts to listen to ambient audio.

Microsoft Journal. Microsoft Journal is a Windows application specifically designed for touch-focused, pen-capable devices such as tablets and 2-in-1 devices. It provides users with freeform personal note-taking experience. The app leverages AI and machine learning to better recognise your handwriting that processes data locally on your device. Users with a Microsoft 365 subscription can access their M365 calendar and contacts within the app. Journal lets you access photos library and the device camera and microphone so that you can add them to a workbook. Learn about Journal app here.

Microsoft PC Manager. Available in select regions, PC Manager is a desktop tool aimed at boosting your PC's performance. Based on your request, PC Manager will scan your device, and allow you to delete unneeded or temporary documents, optimise cache, stop or recover from unauthorised changes, or use other features to improve your PC's performance.

PC Manager will block pop-ups based on ad-block rules and the pop-up windows selected by you through custom block. If you agree to join the "Microsoft PC Manager Pop-up Plan," when you block pop-up windows through custom block, you can help us optimise Microsoft PC Manager's pop-up management feature by taking screenshots of the pop-up and sending them to Microsoft. Microsoft does not collect information other than screenshots, Windows title, and the class of Windows. Screenshots are only retained for a short period of time and regularly deleted. You can manage your Pop-Up Plan preferences through the PC Manager settings. The feedback feature in PC Manager may also process personal data if you include it in the feedback you provide to Microsoft. The feedback from users is regularly deleted after processing.

Circle to Act. Circle to Act is a service offered by PC Manager for selected markets, featuring tools such as Screenshot Tool, Text Extraction, Translation, and Smart Copy. To enable the Smart Copy feature, screenshots you upload during use may be processed by Microsoft in data centres located outside of your location. For the Text Extraction and Translation features, screenshots captured during use will be transmitted to Microsoft Azure, operated and maintained by Microsoft or our local operation partners within your region. These screenshots are processed locally, and the results are returned to you upon completion. Microsoft does not retain any image or text data you submit or the results provided, except where required to comply with legal obligations.

Snipping Tool. The Snipping Tool uses your microphone and pictures library to capture and store screenshots and screen recordings. The Snipping Tool includes a Text Action feature, which uses built-in optical character recognition (OCR) support. You can select and copy text directly from images using OCR. With clipboard integration items copied from the Snipping Tool are also copied to your clipboard. If you enable clipboard history across devices, the copied content can be used seamlessly across different devices. Users can manage their clipboard and snipping preferences through the Windows settings.

Sound Recorder app. The Sound Recorder app is designed for capturing audio via your microphone in various scenarios. While recording, you can mark key moments to easily locate important sections later. You can also trim, adjust volume levels, or apply other modifications as needed, and playback your recordings. Your recordings are autosaved and stored in your Documents folder for easy access, and you can share your recorded audio with friends and family.

Microsoft Clipchamp. Microsoft Clipchamp is a video editor that allows you to combine videos, images, and audio files, as well as add text and effects, and then save the finished video to your device or personal OneDrive via your Microsoft account. You can allow Clipchamp to access your camera and microphone to record videos directly from your device. Clipchamp will collect your imprecise location to provide a better experience, such as choosing which language to display to you.

Media Player. Media Player is Windows' default built-in multimedia player. When you open a multimedia file, Media Player will read the contents of that file. When you open Media Player, it will read the contents of your Music library and

Video library folders to populate its own Music library and Video library pages inside the Media Player to help you organise, view and play multimedia content.

To enrich your experience when playing music, Media Player will automatically attempt to display artist art and album art for the content you play and the content in your music library. To provide this information, Media Player sends an information request to Microsoft containing standard device data, such as your device IP address, device software version, your regional and language settings, and an identifier for the content. You can disable this feature on the app's Settings page.

Movies & TV. Microsoft Movies & TV allows you to rent or buy movies and TV episodes, and play them on your device.

To help you discover content that may interest you, Movies & TV will collect data about what movies and TV shows you watch, including the length of play and any ratings you give.

Movies & TV can also display and play local video files stored on your PC. To do this, it needs access to the video library on your device.

Windows Media Player Legacy. You can use Windows Media Player Legacy to play CDs and other digital content such as video, audio, and picture files, rip CDs, and manage your media library. To enhance your experience, the player displays related media information like album titles, song titles, album art, artist, and composer. To provide additional media details, Windows Media Player Legacy may send a request to Microsoft that includes standard computer information, a media content identifier, and your library's existing media information (including any edits or entries you've made) so Microsoft can recognise the track and return other available information.

Windows Media Player Legacy also allows you to play back content streamed over a network by communicating with streaming media servers, which are usually operated by non-Microsoft content providers. During playback of streaming media, the player may send a log to the streaming media or web server containing details such as connection time, IP address, operating system version, Windows Media Player Legacy version, Player ID number, date, and protocol. To help protect your privacy, the Player ID sent by Windows Media Player Legacy is unique to each session.

Windows Hello

Windows Hello provides instant access to your devices through biometric authentication. If you turn it on, Windows Hello uses unique points or features that are extracted from your face, fingerprint, or iris and stored on your device as a template to identify you—but it does not store the actual image of your face, fingerprint, or iris. Biometric verification data that's used when you sign in doesn't leave your device and remains on your device until you remove it. After a significant period of Windows Hello inactivity, you will be prompted to confirm that you want to continue to store your biometric verification data. You can delete your biometric verification data from within Settings. Learn more about Windows Hello.

Windows Search

Windows Search lets you search your stuff and the web from one place. If you choose to use Windows Search to search "your stuff," it will provide results for items on your personal OneDrive, your OneDrive for Business if so enabled, other supported third-party cloud storage providers and on your device. If you choose to use Windows Search to search the web, or get search suggestions with Windows Search, your search results will be powered by Bing and we will use your search query as described in the Bing section of this privacy statement. Learn more about search in Windows.

Entertainment and related services

Entertainment and related services like XBOX, Microsoft Store, and MSN power rich experiences and enable you to access a variety of content, applications and games. We collect and use your information depending on how you use these services to fuel your experience – for example, we collect your unique identifiers, information about how you interact with in these services, who you chat with, what content you upload, and products you search for and buy. See below for more details about these services, their features, and how they use data.

XBOX

The XBOX network is the online gaming and entertainment service from Microsoft that consists of software and enables online experiences across different platforms. This service lets you find and play games, view content, and connect with friends on XBOX and other gaming and social networks.

When you sign up for an XBOX profile, we assign you a gamertag (a public nickname) and a unique identifier. When you sign in on XBOX devices, apps, and services, the data we collect about your use is stored using your identifiers. Depending on your jurisdiction, you may need to verify your age or identity to access some services or features. If we ask you to verify your age or identity, please refer to the accompanying notice for details about what data is collected and how it is used, and for information about our third-party verification provider. In some cases, we reference the length of your account as well as age signals we receive from operating systems or app stores to better understand your age. If we are unable to verify your age or identity it may cause us to change your settings or access to certain features.

Children under 13 years old or as otherwise specified in your jurisdiction need parental or guardian consent to create an XBOX profile and use the XBOX network. When setting up an XBOX profile for your child, you'll sign in with your own Microsoft account to confirm you're an adult organiser in your family group.

XBOX consoles are devices you can use to find and play games, movies, music, and other digital entertainment. When you sign in to XBOX experiences—in apps or on a console—we also assign a unique identifier to your device. When your XBOX console is connected to the internet, for instance, and you sign in to the console, we identify which console and which version of the console's operating system you're using.

Data we collect about your use of XBOX services, games, apps, and consoles includes:

- When you sign in and sign out of XBOX, any purchases you make, and content you obtain.
- Which games you play and apps you use, your game progress, achievements, play time per game, and other play statistics.
- Performance data about XBOX consoles, XBOX Game Pass and other XBOX apps, the XBOX network, connected accessories, and your network connection, including any software or hardware errors.
- Content you add, upload, or share through the XBOX network, including text, pictures, and video you capture in games and apps.
- Social activity, including chat data and interactions with other gamers, and connections you make (friends you add and people who follow you) on the XBOX network.

If you sign in to use XBOX on another device capable of accessing the XBOX network, and that device includes a storage device (hard drive or memory unit), usage data will be stored on the storage device and sent to Microsoft the next time you sign in to XBOX, even if you've been playing offline.

Data we collect enables us to provide you with our services and with curated experiences. This includes connecting you to games, content, and services, as well as presenting you with offers, discounts, and recommendations. To change your settings for these recommendations, visit the XBOX online safety and privacy settings page.

We collect limited information about children, including their name, birthdate, email address, and region. When you create your child's XBOX profile, you consent to Microsoft collecting, using, and sharing their information, including their personal data, based on their XBOX network privacy and communication settings. Your child's privacy settings start at the most restrictive level by default.

Camera and Microphone. While using XBOX, you can use the device's capabilities such as the microphone, camera, and screen recording to improve your gaming experience.

XBOX diagnostic data. Diagnostic data has two categories: required and optional. Required diagnostic data for XBOX includes information about your device, service performance, how you use our products, apps and services, game activity, and your settings and capabilities.

If your child uses an XBOX console, only the minimum required diagnostic data is sent to Microsoft to help keep XBOX safe, secure, and performing as expected. Optional diagnostic data collection is turned off for child accounts. Please see the section for more information.

Learn more at Manage settings for optional data sharing.

Game captures. Any player in a multiplayer game session can record video (game clips) and capture screenshots of their view of the game play. Other players' game clips and screenshots can capture your in-game character and

gamertag during that session. If a player captures game clips, they might also capture audio chat, depending on their settings.

Captioning. During XBOX real-time ("party") chat, players may activate a voice-to-text feature that lets them view that chat as text. If a player activates this feature, all voice communication in the party is captioned for the player. Microsoft uses the resulting text data to provide captioning of chat for players who need it. This data may also be used to provide a safe gaming environment and enforce the Community Standards for XBOX as well as the other purposes described in this statement.

XBOX data viewable by others. Your gamertag, game and play statistics, achievements, presence (whether you are currently signed in to XBOX), content you share, and other data about your activity on XBOX can be seen by:

- Other players signed in to XBOX.
- Customers of third-party services you've linked your profile to.
- Other services associated with XBOX (including those of partner companies).

Your gamertag and scores that show on game leaderboards are considered public and cannot be hidden. For other data, you can adjust your privacy settings on consoles and at XBOX.com to limit or block what is shared with the public or with friends.

On the XBOX network, your child's online presence (defaulted to "friends"), gamertag, gameplay statistics, and achievements are visible to other players. Depending on your child's safety settings, they might share information when playing or communicating with others on the XBOX network. You can manage these settings to control what is shared.

Learn more at XBOX online safety and privacy settings.

XBOX data shared with game and apps publishers and developers. When you use an XBOX online game or any network-connected app on your XBOX console, PC, or mobile device, the publisher of that game or app has access to data to help the publisher deliver, support, and improve its product. This data includes: your XBOX user identifier; gamertag; limited account info such as country and age range; data about your in-game communications; any XBOX enforcement activity; game-play sessions (for example, moves made in-game, types of vehicles used in-game); your presence on the XBOX network; the time you spend playing the game or app; rankings, statistics, gamer profiles, avatars, or gamerpics; friends lists; activity feeds for official clubs you belong to; official club memberships; and any content you create or submit in the game or app. To stop sharing game or app data with a publisher, remove its games or app from all devices where you have installed them. Some publisher access to your data may be revoked at https://microsoft.com/consent.

Third-party publishers and developers of games and apps have their own distinct and independent relationship with users and their collection and usage of personal data is subject to their specific privacy policies. You should carefully review their policies to determine how they use your data. You may find their policies linked from game or app detail pages in the Microsoft Store.

Learn more at Data Sharing with Games and Apps.

AI-enhanced features. XBOX offers optional AI-enhanced features, including our Support Virtual Agents and Game assist. To provide a response, these AI-enhanced features use your voice or text-based prompt, publicly-available support articles, and other relevant data described in the "" section or within the feature. Additional privacy settings are available within certain XBOX AI-enhanced features, including Game assist. You can view, export, or delete your chats with Game assist in the Copilot section on the Microsoft privacy dashboard.

Family settings. You can use the XBOX Family Settings app to manage your child's experience on the XBOX Network such as spending for the Microsoft and XBOX stores, viewing your child's XBOX activity, and setting age ratings and screen time limits. XBOX-specific Family Safety settings will apply on XBOX console or via XBOX on PC or mobile device but may not be applied on other platforms.

Learn more about managing XBOX profiles at XBOX online safety and privacy settings.

For more information about Microsoft's collection of data from children, including XBOX, please see the Collection of data from children section of this privacy statement.

Safety. In order to help make the XBOX network a safe gaming environment and enforce the Community Standards for XBOX, we may collect and review voice, text, images, videos and in-game content (such as game clips you upload, conversations you have, and things you post in clubs and games).

Anti-cheat and fraud prevention. Providing a fair gameplay environment is important to us. We prohibit cheating, hacking, account stealing, and any other unauthorised or fraudulent activity when you use an XBOX online game or any network-connected app on your XBOX console, PC, or mobile device. In order to detect and prevent fraud and cheating, we may use anti-cheat and fraud prevention tools, applications, and other technologies. Such technologies may create digital signatures (known as "hashes") using certain information collected from your XBOX console, PC, or mobile device, and how you use that device. This can include information about the browser, device, activities, game identifiers, and operating system.

Legacy.

- **XBOX 360**. This XBOX console collects limited required diagnostic data to keep your console functioning as expected while using a console connected to the XBOX network.
- **Kinect**. The Kinect sensor is a combination of camera, microphone, and infrared sensor that can enable motions and voice to be used to control gameplay for titles that support it. Learn more about Kinect at XBOX Kinect and Privacy.

Microsoft Store

Microsoft Store is an online service, accessible via digital storefronts on the web, PC, XBOX consoles, and the XBOX App, that enables you to browse, download, purchase, rate, and review apps, games, subscriptions, in-app extras and add-ons, and other digital content for devices such as PCs, tablets, XBOX consoles, mobile devices, and others.

We collect information about your interactions with Microsoft Store, including: the products you browse, search for, view, add to wish lists or shopping carts, acquire, subscribe to, purchase, install, update, use, delete, uninstall, or for which you request customer support; your product-viewing settings and preferences; and any ratings, reviews, or problem reports you submit. Your Microsoft account is linked to your ratings and reviews, and the name and/or picture associated with your Microsoft account may be shown with any review you post. Microsoft Store also uses your device's region settings to present relevant content and merchandising, and your device identifier to manage product rights tied to your device. Depending on your jurisdiction, you may need to verify your age to allow you to view or acquire certain age-restricted content on Microsoft Store. If we ask you to verify your age, please refer to the accompanying notice for details about what data is collected and how it is used, and for information about our third-party verification provider.

Permission for Microsoft Store apps. Many apps you install from Microsoft Store use specific hardware and software features of your device, which can require access to your data. For example, a photo editing app might access your device's camera to let you take or access photos or videos stored on your device, and a restaurant guide might use your location to provide nearby recommendations. Information about the features that an app uses is provided in its product description page in Microsoft Store.

Many of the features used by apps installed from Microsoft Store can be turned on or off through your device's privacy settings. On Windows, in many cases, you can choose which apps can use a particular feature. Go to **Start > Settings > Privacy or Privacy & Security**, select the feature, and then adjust your app permissions.

App updates. For security and safety purposes, Microsoft Store will automatically check for, download, and install app updates to ensure you have the latest versions. You can pause this feature in your Microsoft Store settings. Microsoft Store only updates apps that were installed from Microsoft Store, and not apps installed from other sources. If an updated app seeks new access to certain features—such as your location—you will be prompted for consent. You can review the hardware and software features an app uses by viewing its product description page in Microsoft Store.

Any personal data that an app collects and uses is subject to the app developer's privacy policy, which the app developer must provide via a link on the app's product description page in Microsoft Store.

Acquiring content from sources other than Microsoft Store. Some Microsoft computing environments, such as Windows, may enable you to use third-party sources, such as third-party apps, app stores, or websites, to browse, search for, acquire, purchase, download, or install apps, games, and other digital content. The privacy information described here does not apply to your use of or acquisitions from those third-party sources.

MSN

MSN (formerly known as Microsoft Start or Microsoft News) is a content service that includes news, weather, sports, and finance. The MSN app is available on various platforms, including iOS and Android. The MSN service is also included within other Microsoft services, including the Microsoft Edge browser and widgets on Windows.

When you install the MSN app, MSN Weather, or Microsoft News apps, we collect data that tells us if the app was installed properly, the installation date, the app version, and other data about your device such as the operating system and browser. This data is collected on a regular basis to help us determine the number of app users and identify performance issues associated with different app versions, operating systems, and browsers. When you use the weather app, we use your location to provide you with relevant weather content.

We also collect data about how you interact with MSN content, such as usage frequency and articles viewed, to provide you with relevant content. MSN provides an enhanced experience when you sign in with your Microsoft account, including allowing you to customise your interests and favourites. We use your location to provide you with relevant content such as local weather and news. You can manage personalisation through MSN and Bing settings, as well as through settings in other Microsoft services that include MSN services. We also use the data we collect to provide you with advertisements that may be of interest to you. You can opt out of interest-based advertising through the advertising links within MSN services, or by visiting the Microsoft opt-out page.

Previous versions of MSN Money allow you to access personal finance information from third-party financial institutions. MSN Money only displays this information and does not store it on our servers. Your sign-in credentials used to access your financial information from third parties are encrypted on your device and are not sent to Microsoft. These financial institutions, as well as any other third-party services you access through MSN services, are subject to their own terms and privacy policies.

Windows Mixed Reality

Windows Mixed Reality allows you to enable a virtual reality experience that immerses you in apps and games. Mixed Reality uses a compatible headset's camera, microphone, and infrared sensors to enable motions and voice to be used to control gameplay and to navigate apps and games.

Microsoft collects diagnostic data to solve problems and to keep Mixed Reality running on Windows up to date, secure, and operating properly. Diagnostic data also helps us improve Mixed Reality and related Microsoft products and services depending on the diagnostic data settings you've chosen for your device. Learn more about Windows diagnostic data.

Mixed Reality also processes and collects data specifically related to the Mixed Reality experiences, such as:

- Mixed Reality maps distances between your body's joints to create a stick figure representation of you. If you are connected to the Internet, we collect those numeric values to enable and improve your experience.
- Mixed Reality detects specific hand gestures intended to perform simple system interactions (such as menu navigation, pan/zoom, and scroll). This data is processed on your PC and is not stored.
- The headset's microphones enable voice commands to control games, apps, or to enter search terms. Learn more about voice data collection.
- Windows Mixed Reality can also be used for audio and video communications.

© Microsoft 2026